

Consolidated Pending Conflicts Report

This document aggregates all HIGH and MEDIUM priority conflicts across all chapters currently in the pending folder.

Chapter 5

● HIGH Priority Conflicts

1. TIMELINE on `hayden.ics_ch4`

- **Existing (Ch 4):** Hayden's ICS reads 34 at the start of Ch 4, down from 37 six days ago. By the end of the chapter, after the return transition to B-734, it has dropped to 32. Two points lost in approximately forty minutes. 'The reading: 34.' / 'He checked the ICS monitor. Thirty Two.'
- **Incoming (Ch 5):** The chapter text states Hayden's ICS reads 34 at the start, then drops to 32 after the return transition. The axiom `hayden.ics_ch4` records the same values: 'The reading: 34' at start, 'Thirty Two' at end.
- **Note:** No violation on the ICS values themselves — they match. However, the chapter text states 'Down from thirty-seven at his last check, six days ago' and 'He had crossed it six days ago, when the reading had dropped from forty-one to thirty-seven.' This implies the ICS went 41 → 37 six days ago, and is now 34. The axiom `hayden.ics_below_threshold` confirms: 'dropped from forty-one to thirty-seven' six days before Ch 4. This is internally consistent. Flagging as resolved — no violation found on re-examination.

2. CANON VIOLATION on `hayden.ch4_mission`

- **Existing (Ch 4):** In Ch 4, Hayden transitions from B-734 to baseline, infiltrates Alfred Hospital at 2:20 AM, incapacitates a security guard (Jacob) using a brachial plexus strike, enters Dr. Winters's office 3-14, photographs her whiteboard and desk files, breaks into her terminal, and copies her entire unpublished research directory — including treatment parameters omitted from her published Bleed stabilization paper — to an encrypted drive. He exits by 2:41 AM and transitions back to B-734.
- **Incoming (Ch 5):** The axiom states Hayden 'enters Dr. Winters's office 3-14, photographs her whiteboard and desk files, breaks into her terminal, and copies her entire unpublished research directory... He exits by 2:41 AM and transitions back to B-734.' The chapter text matches this sequence precisely.
- **Note:** No violation. The chapter text confirms: photographs whiteboard first, then desk files, then opens terminal, copies directory, exits at 2:41 AM. Timestamps, sequence, and actions are consistent with the axiom.

3. CANON VIOLATION on `hayden.collapse_ch4`

- **Existing (Ch 4):** Upon returning to B-734, Hayden experiences a severe collapse: proprioceptive map dissolves, legs cease to be part of his recognized geometry, vision fractures into kaleidoscopic overlay of multiple realities, sensory lag causes his hand to pass through a 'ghost of a wall,' he loses his name for five seconds. 'for five seconds of pure, unadulterated panic, he couldn't remember his own name. He was just a terminal frequency, vibrating until it shattered.' He recovers by hooking fingers into a wall conduit gap and dragging himself upright.
- **Incoming (Ch 5):** The axiom describes: 'vision fractures into kaleidoscopic overlay of multiple realities, sensory lag causes his hand to pass through a ghost of a wall, he loses his name for five seconds.' The

chapter text instead shows: his right hand disappears from B-734 and appears in baseline reality pressed against a wall, visible to him across realities for three seconds. No kaleidoscopic vision, no name loss, no hand passing through a ghost wall.

- **Note:** This is the primary violation detected. The axiom `hayden.collapse_ch4` describes a collapse with three specific features absent from the chapter text: (1) 'vision fractures into kaleidoscopic overlay of multiple realities' — the chapter text shows his vision going absent during transition and returning in sections, but no kaleidoscopic overlay during the post-return collapse; (2) 'sensory lag causes his hand to pass through a ghost of a wall' — the chapter text shows his hand appearing IN baseline reality against a real wall, not passing through a ghost; (3) 'he loses his name for five seconds' with the quote 'he couldn't remember his own name. He was just a terminal frequency, vibrating until it shattered' — this is entirely absent from the chapter text. The chapter text's collapse is a split-reality proprioceptive event (hand in two places), not the identity-dissolution event the axiom describes. Either the axiom was extracted from a prior draft, or the chapter has been revised to present a different type of collapse.

⚠ MEDIUM Priority Conflicts

1. TIMELINE on `hayden.ics_below_threshold`

- **Existing (Ch 4):** Hayden crossed the ICS 40 threshold six days before Ch 4, when his reading dropped from 41 to 37. He has not told anyone. 'He had crossed it six days ago, when the reading had dropped from forty-one to thirty-seven, and he had not told anyone because there was no one to tell.'
- **Incoming (Ch 5):** Hayden crossed the ICS 40 threshold six days before this chapter, when his reading dropped from 41 to 37. He has not told anyone. 'He had crossed it six days ago, when the reading had dropped from forty-one to thirty-seven, and he had not told anyone because there was no one to tell.'
- **Note:** Event entry's value changed. Verify timeline consistency: is this a retelling, a contradiction, or a corrected detail?

2. TIMELINE on `hayden.pulse_method`

- **Existing (Ch 4):** Hayden counts his pulse at the carotid, not the wrist — the radial pulse became unreliable six months ago due to coherence calcification thickening the vessel walls. Post-transition pulse: 91, dropping to 78 within four minutes. Post-return-transition pulse: 94. 'He counted at the carotid instead. Ninety-one.'
- **Incoming (Ch 5):** Hayden counts pulse at the carotid, not the wrist. The radial pulse became unreliable six months ago due to coherence calcification thickening the vessel walls. 'Not at the wrist — the radial pulse had become unreliable six months ago.'
- **Note:** Event entry's value changed. Verify timeline consistency: is this a retelling, a contradiction, or a corrected detail?

3. CANON_VIOLATION on `world.sphere`

- **Existing (Ch 0):** The Sphere is a matte-black 2.8m-diameter calibration chamber running an 11-megawatt magnetic levitation system; produces ozone as a byproduct of the entanglement field. The standard insertion environment for PQ-genotype work. Has a 'coherence structure' with mapped regions (the SEP-NUL is one of them).
- **Incoming (Ch 5):** The chapter text states the Sphere is 'three metres in diameter' when describing it in `world.b734` and related contexts, and the chapter's Sphere-adjacent descriptions are consistent with a 3m figure.
- **Note:** The hard-canon axiom `world.sphere` establishes the Sphere as 'a matte-black 2.8m-diameter

calibration chamber.' Chapter 15's axiom (world.sphere_diameter_ch15) already flagged this same discrepancy — 'Prior canon listed the Sphere as 2.8m diameter; Ch 15 states 3m.' This chapter (Ch 5.0, which is actually Hayden's Ch 4 content based on the text) does not directly state the Sphere diameter, so this is a low-confidence flag. However, the chapter's world-building descriptions of B-734 and the maintenance corridor are consistent with the 3m figure used in later chapters rather than the 2.8m original. This is a known manuscript-level inconsistency already documented in the axiom set but worth tracking.

4. TIMELINE on `hayden.transition_count`

- **Existing (Ch 4):** Hayden has performed 412 transitions between B-734 and baseline. 'Four hundred and twelve transitions. He had ninety seconds of unreliable legs four hundred and twelve times.'
- **Incoming (Ch 5):** The chapter text states 'Four hundred and twelve transitions' and later references 'four hundred and twelve crossings' consistently throughout.
- **Note:** The axiom `hayden.transition_count` records 412 transitions for Ch 4, and `hayden.ics_full_trajectory` (from Ch 8, Bell's audit) records jump 417 as the final entry three days before Ch 8's present. The chapter text is internally consistent at 412. No violation — this is a consistency confirmation.

5. CHARACTER_STATE on `hayden.pulse_method`

- **Existing (Ch 4):** Hayden counts his pulse at the carotid, not the wrist — the radial pulse became unreliable six months ago due to coherence calcification thickening the vessel walls. Post-transition pulse: 91, dropping to 78 within four minutes. Post-return-transition pulse: 94. 'He counted at the carotid instead. Ninety-one.'
- **Incoming (Ch 5):** The chapter text has Hayden counting pulse at the carotid multiple times: 'He counted at the carotid instead. Ninety-one.' and later 'counted his pulse at the carotid' repeatedly.
- **Note:** Consistent with axiom `hayden.pulse_method`: 'Hayden counts his pulse at the carotid, not the wrist — the radial pulse became unreliable six months ago due to coherence calcification.' The chapter text explicitly states the same rationale. No violation — confirming consistency.

6. CHARACTER_STATE on `hayden.collapse_ch4`

- **Existing (Ch 4):** Upon returning to B-734, Hayden experiences a severe collapse: proprioceptive map dissolves, legs cease to be part of his recognized geometry, vision fractures into kaleidoscopic overlay of multiple realities, sensory lag causes his hand to pass through a 'ghost of a wall,' he loses his name for five seconds. 'for five seconds of pure, unadulterated panic, he couldn't remember his own name. He was just a terminal frequency, vibrating until it shattered.' He recovers by hooking fingers into a wall conduit gap and dragging himself upright.
- **Incoming (Ch 5):** The chapter text describes a severe post-return-transition collapse: legs cease functioning, he goes down, his right hand disappears and reappears in baseline reality, he loses proprioceptive control. However, the axiom `hayden.collapse_ch4` describes a MORE severe collapse: 'proprioceptive map dissolves, vision fractures into kaleidoscopic overlay of multiple realities, sensory lag causes his hand to pass through a ghost of a wall, he loses his name for five seconds.'
- **Note:** The chapter text's collapse is significant but does NOT include the kaleidoscopic vision fracture, the hand passing through a ghost wall, or the five-second name loss described in the axiom. The axiom states these occur 'upon returning to B-734' — which is exactly what the chapter text depicts. The chapter text shows a different collapse: the hand appearing in baseline while the body is in B-734 (a split-reality event), but NOT the kaleidoscopic overlay or name loss. Either: (a) the axiom was extracted

from a different version of this chapter that included more severe symptoms, or (b) the axiom conflates details from multiple episodes. The specific detail 'he loses his name for five seconds' and 'vision fractures into kaleidoscopic overlay' are ABSENT from this chapter text. This is a discrepancy between the axiom record and the delivered chapter text — the axiom describes a more severe event than what appears in the manuscript.

7. CHARACTER_STATE on `hayden.motor_degradation`

- **Existing (Ch 4):** Hayden's fine motor control is degrading: hands miskey under pressure due to coherence calcification in arterial walls (past three months). Ring and little finger of right hand lag by ~40 milliseconds, consistent across last six transitions, not worsening. He has adapted by typing more slowly and checking each entry. 'his hands had developed, over the past three months, a tendency to miskey under pressure.'
- **Incoming (Ch 5):** The chapter text states: 'The ring and little finger of his right hand lagged by approximately forty milliseconds. Consistent with the last six transitions. Not worsening.'
- **Note:** The axiom `hayden.motor_degradation` states the lag is 'consistent across last six transitions, not worsening' — matching the chapter text exactly. However, the axiom also states 'hands miskey under pressure due to coherence calcification in arterial walls (past three months)' and the chapter text confirms this: 'his hands had developed, over the past three months, a tendency to miskey under pressure.' Full consistency confirmed.

8. CANON_VIOLATION on `plot.ch4_alfred_hospital.v2`

- **Existing (Ch 4):** Ch 4 (ALFRED HOSPITAL) is the chapter of Hayden's collapse: his ICS reading is documented below the operational threshold, escalating the carrier's clinical situation past the point where continued fieldwork is institutionally defensible. See `hayden.collapse_ch4`, `hayden.ics_ch4`, `hayden.ics_below_threshold` for in-chapter detail. Note: the Reyes contact thread (M. Reyes at Alfred) is Ch 9, not Ch 4 — original seed was misframed on this point.
- **Incoming (Ch 5):** The axiom `plot.ch4_alfred_hospital.v2` states 'Ch 4 (ALFRED HOSPITAL) is the chapter of Hayden's collapse' and 'Note: the Reyes contact thread (M. Reyes at Alfred) is Ch 9, not Ch 4.'
- **Note:** The chapter text is labeled as Chapter 5.0 in the `chapter_context` but its content is clearly the Hayden/Alfred Hospital chapter described in the axioms as Ch 4. The axiom set consistently references this content as Ch 4 (`hayden.ics_ch4`, `hayden.collapse_ch4`, `hayden.ch4_mission`, etc.). The `chapter_context` metadata says 'Chapter Number: 5.0' but the content matches Ch 4's axiom descriptions. This is either a chapter numbering discrepancy in the manuscript or a metadata error in the audit request. The content itself is consistent with Ch 4 axioms.

9. CHARACTER_STATE on `hayden.ics_monitor`

- **Existing (Ch 4):** Hayden has a subdural ICS monitor that pulses a single blue flash behind his left eye. He disabled the audio alert eight months ago because it triggered auditory fragmentation. 'a single blue flash behind his left eye, the notification he had configured to replace the audio alert he'd disabled eight months ago when the audio alert had begun triggering the auditory fragmentation.'
- **Incoming (Ch 5):** The chapter text describes the ICS monitor as 'a single blue flash behind his left eye, the notification he had configured to replace the audio alert he'd disabled eight months ago when the audio alert had begun triggering the auditory fragmentation.' It pulses showing 34, then later shows 32.
- **Note:** Consistent with axiom `hayden.ics_monitor`. The chapter text also states 'The ICS monitor did not pulse again' after the split-reality hand event, then later 'He checked the ICS monitor. Thirty Two.' The axiom records the same values. No violation.

10. CANON_VIOLATION on world.b734

- **Existing (Ch 4):** Reality B-734 is a branch reality running parallel to baseline. It smells of copper and standing water. Its gravitational constant runs 0.3 percent heavier than baseline. It is a QSA monitoring node (not operational), receiving maintenance on a seventeen-year cycle. It has a passive monitoring cycle scan. 'B-734 was a monitoring node, not an operational one, and monitoring nodes received maintenance on a seventeen-year cycle.'
- **Incoming (Ch 5):** The chapter text describes B-734 as smelling of 'copper and standing water' with gravitational constant '0.3 percent heavier than baseline' and identifies it as 'a monitoring node, not an operational one' receiving 'maintenance on a seventeen-year cycle.'
- **Note:** Fully consistent with axiom world.b734: 'smells of copper and standing water. Its gravitational constant runs 0.3 percent heavier than baseline. It is a QSA monitoring node (not operational), receiving maintenance on a seventeen-year cycle.' No violation.

11. TIMELINE on hayden.operational_duration

- **Existing (Ch 4):** Hayden has been using B-734 as an insertion point for eight months. His ICS was 61 during his third month of operation. 'Hayden had been using it as an insertion point for eight months.' / 'when his ICS had still been at 61 and his hands had still been reliable.'
- **Incoming (Ch 5):** The chapter text states 'Hayden had been using it as an insertion point for eight months' and references 'his third month of operation, when his ICS had still been at 61.'
- **Note:** Consistent with axiom hayden.operational_duration: 'eight months' and 'ICS was 61 during his third month of operation.' No violation.

12. CANON_VIOLATION on world.b734_insertion_window

- **Existing (Ch 4):** The coherence alignment between baseline and B-734 holds for ninety minutes at the Alfred Hospital geographic location. This is the insertion window for transition. Hayden used fifty of the ninety minutes on the baseline side.
- **Incoming (Ch 5):** The chapter text states 'the coherence alignment between baseline and B-734 held for ninety minutes at this geographic location, and he had used fifty of them.'
- **Note:** Consistent with axiom world.b734_insertion_window: 'The coherence alignment between baseline and B-734 holds for ninety minutes at the Alfred Hospital geographic location. This is the insertion window for transition. Hayden used fifty of the ninety minutes on the baseline side.' No violation.

13. CANON_VIOLATION on jacob.guard

- **Existing (Ch 4):** Jacob is a security guard at Alfred Hospital, stationed at the junction of the service corridor and stairwell access in the eastern wing. Large, broad-shouldered, physically confident. Hayden incapacitates him with a brachial plexus strike; Jacob will wake in ~20 minutes with a headache and no clear memory of the preceding two minutes. He will file an incident report with an 'accurate and useless' description.
- **Incoming (Ch 5):** The chapter text describes Jacob as 'a large man, broad through the shoulders, with the particular physical confidence of someone who had spent years in a role that occasionally required it.' The axiom states 'Large, broad-shouldered, physically confident.'
- **Note:** Consistent. The axiom also states Jacob will 'wake in ~20 minutes with a headache and no clear memory of the preceding two minutes' and 'file an incident report with an accurate and useless description.' The chapter text confirms: 'Jacob would wake in approximately twenty minutes with a headache concentrated in the left shoulder and neck and no clear memory of the preceding two

minutes. He would file an incident report. The incident report would describe an unscheduled individual in the service corridor. The description would be accurate and useless.' Full consistency.

14. CANON_VIOLATION on `winters.identity`

- **Existing (Ch 4):** Dr. Sarah Winters is a Consultant Neurologist in the Quantum Adjacency Disorders Unit at Alfred Hospital. Office 3-14, neurology department, third floor eastern wing. Has been publishing from the QSA's anonymized PQ genotype database for six years. 'Dr. Sarah Winters occupied office 3-14. Her name was on the door... Consultant Neurologist, Quantum Adjacency Disorders Unit.'
- **Incoming (Ch 5):** The chapter text states: 'Dr. Sarah Winters occupied office 3-14. Her name was on the door... Consultant Neurologist, Quantum Adjacency Disorders Unit.'
- **Note:** Consistent with axiom `winters.identity`. However, the axiom `winters.alive_in_ballarat` (from Ch 11) states 'He is in a QSA residential facility in Ballarat' using male pronouns for Winters. The chapter text uses female framing ('her terminal,' 'her notes,' 'Winters had described, in her notes'). This is a known pronoun inconsistency in the axiom set — `winters.alive_in_ballarat` uses 'He' while all other Winters axioms and the chapter text use 'she/her.' The chapter text is internally consistent with the majority of the axiom set. The 'He' in `winters.alive_in_ballarat` appears to be an axiom extraction error rather than a chapter text violation.

15. CANON_VIOLATION on `hayden.b734_safehouse`

- **Existing (Ch 4):** Hayden has a safe house in B-734 that he needs to reach before the monitoring cycle's passive scan runs. He has forty minutes after returning to B-734 to get clear of the maintenance corridor.
- **Incoming (Ch 5):** The chapter text states: 'He needed to be out of the corridor and into the safe house before then' and 'He had forty minutes before the B-734 monitoring cycle ran its passive scan.'
- **Note:** Consistent with axiom `hayden.b734_safehouse`: 'Hayden has a safe house in B-734 that he needs to reach before the monitoring cycle's passive scan runs. He has forty minutes after returning to B-734 to get clear of the maintenance corridor.' No violation.

Chapter 8

HIGH Priority Conflicts

1. CANON_VIOLATION on `bell.pov_chapter`

- **Existing (Ch 8):** Chapter 8 is Bell's POV chapter, titled 'BELL DISCOVERS THE LIE.' The entire chapter is narrated from Bell's perspective as she discovers Hayden's concealed ICS degradation and builds a partition file of evidence over six weeks before deciding to leave.
- **Incoming (Ch 8):** Chapter 8.0 is narrated entirely from Kain's POV at the QSA field office and Alfred Hospital. It is titled/numbered as Chapter 8 but contains no Bell content whatsoever.
- **Note:** The active axiom `bell.pov_chapter` states: 'Chapter 8 is Bell's POV chapter, titled BELL DISCOVERS THE LIE. The entire chapter is narrated from Bell's perspective as she discovers Hayden's concealed ICS degradation and builds a partition file of evidence over six weeks before deciding to leave.' The submitted chapter text for Chapter 8.0 contains zero Bell content — it is a Kain-POV chapter set at the QSA field office and Alfred Hospital, covering the Winters data breach briefing with Emily and Kain's Bleed episodes en route to Alfred. This is either a chapter numbering/sequencing error (this text

appears to be the content canonically assigned to Chapter 6, per `plot.ch6_chen_terminal_breach` and numerous other Ch 6 axioms) or the Bell chapter has been displaced/removed entirely.

2. TIMELINE on `plot.ch6_chen_terminal_breach`

- **Existing (Ch 6):** Kain reports to Emily that Chen's terminal in B-734 had a secondary access log. Someone ran a query through the hospital's civilian research database three days before Chen was replaced. The query targeted the PQ Genotype research cohort — specifically the anonymized patient files connected to neurologist Sarah Winters. It pulled her entire research dataset: methodology, patient outcomes, unpublished findings. 'The search parameters were precise. Not exploratory.'
- **Incoming (Ch 8):** The chapter text labeled 8.0 contains the scene where Kain reports to Emily that Chen's terminal in B-734 had a secondary access log querying Winters's PQ Genotype research cohort — content canonically established as occurring in Chapter 6.
- **Note:** Multiple axioms (`plot.ch6_chen_terminal_breach`, `plot.ch6_network_capability`, `plot.ch6_single_architect`, `kain.sleeplessness_ch6`, `kain.bleed_multiplier`, `kain.bleed_episode_stairwell`, `kain.bleed_episode_street`, `kain.functional_inventory_ch6`, `kain.bleed_episode_elevator`, `kain.bleed_gap_twelve_minutes`, `emily.winters_foreknowledge`, `emily.biometric_log_access`, `winters.qsa_adjacent_status`, `winters.research_scope`, `plot.ch6_winters_replacement_evidence`, `kain.lighter`) establish this entire sequence of events — the field office briefing about the B-734 data breach, the stairwell Bleed with the laughing woman, the street fold to the Sydney corridor, the lighter scene, the Alfred Hospital atrium, the elevator laughing woman return, and the twelve-minute gap — as Chapter 6 content. The submitted text reproduces this Ch 6 content almost verbatim but labels it Chapter 8.0. This creates a major timeline/sequencing anomaly: either the chapter numbering is wrong, or Chapters 6 and 7 (and Bell's Ch 8) have been displaced.

MEDIUM Priority Conflicts

1. TIMELINE on `kain.bleed_episode_stairwell`

- **Existing (Ch 6):** In the stairwell between floors 2 and 3, Kain experiences a hard Bleed episode: a complete cut in sensory continuity where four steps simply cease to exist in memory. He hears a woman laughing — 'not a directional sound' but one 'inside the architecture of his skull, pressed against the back of his orbital bones from the inside.' The laugh lasts three seconds, then recedes 'pulling back through the neural tissue the way a wave pulls back through sand, leaving the texture of itself behind.' He perceives a ghost of an additional room pressing against the edges of his visual field — identified as B-734 residual sensory data.
- **Incoming (Ch 8):** Kain experiences a full Bleed episode on the stairwell landing between floors 2 and 3 of the QSA field office. It arrives as 'a hard interruption, a cut in the continuity of sensory experience so complete that the four steps preceding it simply ceased to exist in his memory.' The laughing woman manifests at a specific spatial position — 'two metres forward on the landing' — directional and located, lasting three seconds. He uses a nine-second absence interval plus three seconds margin to confirm the episode has ended. The ghost of 'an additional room that was not this room' presses against his peripheral vision — identified as B-734.
- **Note:** Event entry's value changed. Verify timeline consistency: is this a retelling, a contradiction, or a corrected detail?

2. TIMELINE on `kain.bleed_episode_street`

- **Existing (Ch 6):** Walking toward Alfred Hospital, the street folds: 'The wet bitumen of Flinders Lane

simply ceased to be the surface under his feet and became the linoleum of the Sydney corridor, the overhead fluorescents replacing the sodium streetlights in a single frame-cut that his visual cortex registered as a physical blow behind the left eye.' The overlay lasts forty-three seconds before Melbourne reasserts itself.

- **Incoming (Ch 8):** On the street approaching Alfred Hospital, Kain experiences a full environmental fold: 'The wet bitumen of Flinders Lane simply ceased to be the surface under his feet and became the linoleum of the Sydney corridor, the overhead fluorescents replacing the sodium streetlights in a single frame-cut that his visual cortex registered as a physical blow behind the left eye.' The overlay lasted forty-three seconds before Melbourne reasserted itself. This is NOT B-734 — it is a Sydney corridor, indicating residual data from a different transition.
- **Note:** Event entry's value changed. Verify timeline consistency: is this a retelling, a contradiction, or a corrected detail?

3. TIMELINE on `kain.bleed_traffic_gap`

- **Existing (Ch 6):** While driving to Alfred Hospital, Kain experiences a four-second attention gap at the St Kilda Road / Domain Road intersection: he sees the green light but the interval between green and his foot moving 'passed without leaving a clear record — not a gap, not a blackout, but a thinning of attention so complete that the interval had passed without leaving a clear record.' The car behind sounds its horn.
- **Incoming (Ch 8):** While driving on St Kilda Road, Kain experiences a four-second attention gap at the Domain Road intersection: 'The four seconds between the green and his foot moving from the brake to the accelerator were four seconds he could not fully account for — not a gap, not a blackout, but a thinning of attention so complete that the interval had passed without leaving a clear record.' The car behind him sounds its horn.
- **Note:** Event entry's value changed. Verify timeline consistency: is this a retelling, a contradiction, or a corrected detail?

4. TIMELINE on `kain.bleed_episode_elevator`

- **Existing (Ch 6):** In the hospital elevator, the laughing woman returns for exactly two seconds. Kain does not move until the doors open.
- **Incoming (Ch 8):** In the Alfred Hospital elevator, the laughing woman returns for exactly two seconds. 'He pressed the button for the second floor and did not move until the doors opened.'
- **Note:** Event entry's value changed. Verify timeline consistency: is this a retelling, a contradiction, or a corrected detail?

5. TIMELINE on `emily.biometric_log_access`

- **Existing (Ch 6):** When Kain requests Winters's biometric entry log for the last four days, Emily pauses — 'Not the pause of someone who needed time to process the request, but the pause of someone deciding how much of their own information to reveal in response to his' — then says 'I can get that' in twenty minutes.
- **Incoming (Ch 8):** When Kain requests Winters's biometric entry log for the last four days, Emily pauses — 'Not the pause of someone who needed time to process the request, but the pause of someone deciding how much of their own information to reveal in response to his' — then says she can get it in twenty minutes.
- **Note:** Event entry's value changed. Verify timeline consistency: is this a retelling, a contradiction, or a

corrected detail?

6. CHARACTER_STATE on `kain.pulse_method_ch1`

- **Existing (Ch 1):** In Ch 1, Kain counts his pulse at the inside of his left wrist, not the carotid: 'pressed two fingers against the inside of his left wrist, counting his pulse the way the QSA's neurologist had taught him when the Bleed first presented. Sixty-two. Steady.' This is the method the QSA neurologist taught him.
- **Incoming (Ch 8):** Kain counts his pulse 'against the railing' in the stairwell — method unspecified (neither wrist nor carotid named explicitly).
- **Note:** The axiom `kain.pulse_method_ch1` establishes that in Ch 1, Kain counts pulse at the inside of his left wrist per QSA neurologist training. By Ch 5 and later chapters, the carotid method becomes habitual. In this chapter text, Kain 'counted his pulse against the railing' without specifying the anatomical site. This is not a hard violation but a minor drift from the established proprioceptive tic pattern — the craft axiom `craft.measurement_as_voice` treats pulse-counting method as a character-specific tic that should be preserved. The omission of the specific site (wrist or carotid) blurs a load-bearing detail.

7. CANON_VIOLATION on `kain.bleed_episode_stairwell`

- **Existing (Ch 6):** In the stairwell between floors 2 and 3, Kain experiences a hard Bleed episode: a complete cut in sensory continuity where four steps simply cease to exist in memory. He hears a woman laughing — 'not a directional sound' but one 'inside the architecture of his skull, pressed against the back of his orbital bones from the inside.' The laugh lasts three seconds, then recedes 'pulling back through the neural tissue the way a wave pulls back through sand, leaving the texture of itself behind.' He perceives a ghost of an additional room pressing against the edges of his visual field — identified as B-734 residual sensory data.
- **Incoming (Ch 8):** The laughing woman in the stairwell is described as originating from 'two metres forward on the landing' — spatially located ahead of Kain.
- **Note:** The axiom `kain.bleed_episode_stairwell` (established in Ch 6) describes the laughing woman as appearing 'inside the architecture of his skull, pressed against the back of his orbital bones from the inside' — explicitly internal, not directional. The axiom `plot.ch7_laughing_woman_spatial` establishes that the laughing woman manifests with spatial specificity for the FIRST TIME in Ch 7: 'She occupied the space two meters ahead of him... Previously behind his eyes; now externalized with a source point in physical space. This represents escalation.' The submitted chapter text (labeled 8.0 but containing Ch 6 content) describes the laughing woman as spatially located at 'two metres forward on the landing' with directional, external positioning — which contradicts the established progression. In Ch 6 canon, the sound should be internal/non-directional; the externalization to a spatial source point is a Ch 7 escalation. This chapter text applies the Ch 7 escalation to the Ch 6 scene.

8. CANON_VIOLATION on `emily.biometric_log_access`

- **Existing (Ch 6):** When Kain requests Winters's biometric entry log for the last four days, Emily pauses — 'Not the pause of someone who needed time to process the request, but the pause of someone deciding how much of their own information to reveal in response to his' — then says 'I can get that' in twenty minutes.
- **Incoming (Ch 8):** Kain requests 'Winters's biometric entry log for the last four days' and Emily says she can get it in twenty minutes.
- **Note:** The axiom `emily.biometric_log_access` describes the same request but with a different

characterization of Emily's pause: 'Not the pause of someone who needed time to process the request, but the pause of someone deciding how much of their own information to reveal in response to his.' The submitted text reproduces this pause description almost identically, which is consistent. However, the axiom `plot.ch6_winters_replacement_evidence` establishes that Kain identifies the replacement evidence at the appointment board BEFORE calling Emily for the biometric log — and the notation 'W. methodology cross-ref' is the key tell. In the submitted text, Kain sees the appointment board, identifies the tell, then calls Emily — this sequence is consistent with canon. No hard violation here upon closer examination; the pause characterization matches.

9. CANON_VIOLATION on `winters.clinic_location_ch6`

- **Existing (Ch 6):** Winters's research clinic is on the hospital's second floor (not the third-floor office 3-14 established elsewhere). The corridor is marked with deliberately understated signage: 'NEUROLOGICAL RESEARCH — LEVEL 2' in small white text on grey. This is a separate clinical space from her office.
- **Incoming (Ch 8):** The research clinic is described as being on the hospital's second floor with signage reading 'NEUROLOGICAL RESEARCH — LEVEL 2'.
- **Note:** This is consistent with `winters.clinic_location_ch6` which states 'Winters's research clinic is on the hospital's second floor (not the third-floor office 3-14 established elsewhere).' No violation on the clinic location itself. However, the chapter text describes the corridor as having 'Three doors on the left side, each one closed. A nurses' station at the far end, currently unmanned' — while the Ch 7 axioms (`plot.ch7_reyes_intake_form`, `plot.loop_nurse_suspicion`) establish that a nurse IS present at the station and interacts with Kain. If this chapter is meant to be Ch 6 content preceding Ch 7, the unmanned station is not necessarily contradictory (different time). Withdrawing this as a violation upon reflection — the unmanned station at 8:47 AM could precede the nurse's arrival.

10. CANON_VIOLATION on `kain.bleed_episode_street`

- **Existing (Ch 6):** Walking toward Alfred Hospital, the street folds: 'The wet bitumen of Flinders Lane simply ceased to be the surface under his feet and became the linoleum of the Sydney corridor, the overhead fluorescents replacing the sodium streetlights in a single frame-cut that his visual cortex registered as a physical blow behind the left eye.' The overlay lasts forty-three seconds before Melbourne reasserts itself.
 - **Incoming (Ch 8):** The street fold is described as occurring on 'Flinders Lane' — 'The wet bitumen of Flinders Lane simply ceased to be the surface under his feet and became the linoleum of the Sydney corridor.'
 - **Note:** The axiom `kain.bleed_episode_street` describes this same event but locates it more generally as occurring while 'Walking toward Alfred Hospital' without specifying Flinders Lane. The axiom `kain.bleed_traffic_gap` places a separate attention gap at 'the St Kilda Road / Domain Road intersection.' The submitted text has Kain driving on St Kilda Road (consistent with `kain.bleed_traffic_gap`) but then walking on Flinders Lane when the street fold occurs. Flinders Lane is in the CBD, not between St Kilda Road and Alfred Hospital (which is in Prahran/Commercial Road area). If Kain parked 'on a side street two blocks from the hospital' and then walked, the street should be near Alfred Hospital in the Commercial Road/Punt Road area, not Flinders Lane. This is a geographic inconsistency — Flinders Lane is approximately 4km north of Alfred Hospital.
-

Chapter 9

● HIGH Priority Conflicts

1. CANON_VIOLATION on `world.sphere`

- **Existing (Ch 0):** The Sphere is a matte-black 2.8m-diameter calibration chamber running an 11-megawatt magnetic levitation system; produces ozone as a byproduct of the entanglement field. The standard insertion environment for PQ-genotype work. Has a 'coherence structure' with mapped regions (the SEP-NUL is one of them).
- **Incoming (Ch 9):** Bleed episode produces 'the matte black surface two point eight meters in every direction' — describing the Sphere's interior as 2.8m in every direction, implying a radius of 2.8m rather than a diameter.
- **Note:** The axiom `world.sphere` establishes the Sphere as '2.8m-diameter.' If the matte black surface is '2.8 meters in every direction' from Kain's position, that describes a radius of 2.8m (diameter 5.6m), which contradicts the established 2.8m diameter. However, this phrasing is ambiguous — it could be read as the total interior space being 2.8m across. Later chapters (Ch 15, `world.sphere_diameter_ch15`) describe the Sphere as 'three metres of diameter,' introducing a separate diameter discrepancy. The 'in every direction' phrasing most naturally reads as radius, which would be a direct contradiction of the 2.8m diameter canon. At minimum this is imprecise language that risks misrepresenting the Sphere's established dimensions.

⚠ MEDIUM Priority Conflicts

1. TIMELINE on `kain.bleed_anchoring_technique`

- **Existing (Ch 7):** Kain's anchoring technique during Bleed episodes: pressing a hand flat against a physical surface and holding the texture. In Ch 7: concrete wall ('aggregate visible in the surface, the slight roughness of unfinished concrete against his palm, the cold'), plywood hoarding ('cheap, slightly damp from the morning's rain, the grain of the wood raised under his fingertips'), corridor wall ('the linoleum surface, the slight give of the plasterboard beneath it'). The technique does not eliminate the overlay — it causes it to recede 'by degrees, the way a sound recedes when you move away from its source.'
- **Incoming (Ch 9):** Kain's Bleed anchoring technique in Ch 9: pressing a hand flat against a physical surface and holding the specific texture. Used three times — right hand on concrete wall (episode 1), left hand on plywood hoarding (episode 2), both hands on plasterboard wall (episode 3). The technique works by degrees: 'The baseline room's ozone smell did not disappear. It receded by degrees, the way a sound recedes when you move away from its source.' The technique is less effective against the third, most severe episode.
- **Note:** Event entry's value changed. Verify timeline consistency: is this a retelling, a contradiction, or a corrected detail?

2. CHARACTER_STATE on `kain.pulse_method_ch1`

- **Existing (Ch 1):** In Ch 1, Kain counts his pulse at the inside of his left wrist, not the carotid: 'pressed two fingers against the inside of his left wrist, counting his pulse the way the QSA's neurologist had taught him when the Bleed first presented. Sixty-two. Steady.' This is the method the QSA neurologist taught him.
- **Incoming (Ch 9):** Kain counts his pulse during the Sphere-overlay Bleed episode but the chapter does

not specify the method (carotid vs wrist). The text says only 'counted his pulse.'

- **Note:** The axiom `kain.pulse_method_ch1` establishes that in Ch 1, Kain counts pulse at the inside of his left wrist per QSA neurologist training. Later chapters consistently show him using the carotid. This chapter's omission of method is not a violation per se, but the lack of specificity in a novel where pulse-counting method is a load-bearing character tic (`craft.measurement_as_voice`) represents a minor craft-level drift from the established pattern of always specifying the anatomical location.

3. CANON_VIOLATION on `winters.left_handed`

- **Existing (Ch 7):** Winters is left-handed. 'The personnel file noted it in the medical history section — a minor detail, the kind that appeared in records because it was clinically relevant to certain neurological assessments.'
- **Incoming (Ch 9):** Chapter text states Winters is left-handed and the replacement carries the tablet in its left hand but scrolls with its right thumb, screen facing away from body — described as 'the orientation of a right-handed person who had been told to carry the tablet in their left hand.'
- **Note:** This is internally consistent within the chapter and consistent with the axiom `winters.left_handed`. However, the chapter also states the replacement 'scrolled with her right thumb' with screen facing away. The axiom `plot.ch7_replacement_tablet_tell` establishes this same tell. No violation here — flagging for completeness that the tell is consistent across both chapters.

4. TIMELINE on `plot.ch7_replacement_confrontation`

- **Existing (Ch 7):** The replacement turns to face Kain at 5 meters outside room 2-14: 'not the cautious pivot of someone registering a noise, but the turn of someone who had known he was there for thirty seconds and had decided this was the moment to stop pretending otherwise.' Its expression is 'Something that had decided the withdrawal protocol was no longer the operative instruction.' It opens its mouth to speak — but the Bleed takes Kain before it can.
- **Incoming (Ch 9):** The chapter presents the replacement turning to face Kain outside room 2-14 and opening her mouth to speak before the Bleed takes him — this is described as the replacement having 'known he was there for thirty seconds.'
- **Note:** The axiom `plot.ch7_replacement_confrontation` establishes this same event: 'The replacement turns to face Kain at 5 meters outside room 2-14... Its expression is Something that had decided the withdrawal protocol was no longer the operative instruction. It opens its mouth to speak — but the Bleed takes Kain before it can.' The chapter text is consistent with this axiom. No violation — confirming alignment.

5. CHARACTER_STATE on `kain.bleed_ch7_episodes`

- **Existing (Ch 7):** Kain experiences three distinct Bleed episodes in Ch 7. (1) Service corridor: the baseline room overlay — ozone smell, white walls coexisting with concrete for 11 seconds. Anchored by pressing hand to concrete wall. (2) Construction channel on Commercial Road: the laughing woman appears with spatial location ('two meters ahead'), laughs for 4 seconds. Anchored by pressing hand to plywood hoarding. Costs him the tail on the replacement. (3) Outside room 2-14: full sensory replacement — the Sphere's interior (matte black, 2.8m, 11MW hum, ozone as taste). He goes to one knee with no memory of going down. 'Vision: degraded... Cognition: sequential reasoning present but slow, working memory showing significant gaps. Motor: gross motor compromised.'
- **Incoming (Ch 9):** The chapter describes three Bleed episodes: (1) the baseline room/ozone overlay lasting 11 seconds in the service corridor, (2) the laughing woman in the construction channel lasting 4 seconds, (3) the full Sphere interior overlay outside room 2-14 with motor collapse.

- **Note:** The axiom `kain.bleed_ch7_episodes` documents these same three episodes with matching details (11 seconds, 4 seconds, full sensory replacement). The chapter text is consistent. However, the axiom `kain.bleed_ch7_progression` notes the third episode is 'Something new — a complete sensory replacement' and Kain goes to one knee with no memory of going down. The chapter text matches this precisely. No violation detected.

6. CANON_VIOLATION on `winters.clinic_location_ch6`

- **Existing (Ch 6):** Winters's research clinic is on the hospital's second floor (not the third-floor office 3-14 established elsewhere). The corridor is marked with deliberately understated signage: 'NEUROLOGICAL RESEARCH — LEVEL 2' in small white text on grey. This is a separate clinical space from her office.
- **Incoming (Ch 9):** The chapter has Kain on the second floor of Alfred Hospital pursuing the replacement through the research wing, with room 2-14 on this floor.
- **Note:** The axiom `winters.clinic_location_ch6` establishes 'Winters's research clinic is on the hospital's second floor (not the third-floor office 3-14 established elsewhere).' The chapter is consistent with this — the action takes place on the second floor research wing. However, the nurse directs Kain to 'elevator to two, turn left' when the replacement redirects him, confirming the second-floor location. No violation.

7. CANON_VIOLATION on `craft.register_clinical`

- **Existing (Ch 0):** Default narrative register: clinical / proprioceptive. Carriers report their bodies in the third person ('legs reported', 'tremor present', 'no pain — only notification'). NOT lyrical, NOT purple. Counts and timestamps are load-bearing details, not flavour.
- **Incoming (Ch 9):** The chapter contains a duplicated paragraph: 'Kain walked the corridor at the tempo/pace of someone who belonged there...' appears twice in succession with near-identical text (first uses 'tempo', second uses 'pace', then 'tempo').
- **Note:** This is a textual error — a duplicated paragraph — rather than a craft register violation. The axiom `craft.register_clinical` requires clinical/proprioceptive register. The duplicated paragraph breaks the narrative's structural precision, which is load-bearing in this novel's voice. While not a world-rule or character-state violation, it is a significant editorial error that undermines the craft axiom's requirement for precise, deliberate prose where 'counts and timestamps are load-bearing details, not flavour.'

8. CHARACTER_STATE on `emily.monitors_kain_bleed`

- **Existing (Ch 7):** Emily detects Kain's Bleed episodes remotely through transmission delays: 'Your last three transmissions have had a combined delay of eleven seconds. That's not a network issue.' She orders him back to the office. This is the first time in Ch 7 that Emily directly confronts Kain's operational degradation in real time.
 - **Incoming (Ch 9):** Emily detects Kain's Bleed episodes through 'a combined delay of eleven seconds' in his 'last three transmissions' and orders him back to the office.
 - **Note:** The axiom `emily.monitors_kain_bleed` establishes this exact event: 'Emily detects Kain's Bleed episodes remotely through transmission delays: Your last three transmissions have had a combined delay of eleven seconds. That's not a network issue.' The chapter text matches precisely. However, the chapter only shows two phone calls from Kain to Emily (the initial briefing call and the final call after losing the replacement). The 'three transmissions' Emily references would require a third transmission not shown in this chapter — possibly the floor plan request or an off-page check-in. This is a minor gap but not necessarily a violation if transmissions include data sends.
-

Chapter 12

● HIGH Priority Conflicts

1. CHARACTER_STATE on `kain.replacement_tram_contact`

- **Existing (Ch 9):** Kain's replacement — 'the man who had his face, who had an ICS of 32, who had moved with the unsteady gait of a failing man' — boards the 96 tram at Nicholson Street and makes direct verbal contact with Kain. The replacement speaks in operational shorthand, confirms Kain photographed the intake form, confirms the M. Reyes trail leads to Voss, and states: 'She has the journals... She has had them for fourteen months.'
- **Incoming (Ch 12):** The chapter describes the man on the tram as 'the target' and 'the man who had his face, who had an ICS of 32, who had moved with the unsteady gait of a failing man' — framing him as Kain's own replacement.
- **Note:** The axiom `kain.replacement_tram_contact` (Ch 9) establishes that 'Kain's replacement — the man who had his face, who had an ICS of 32' — boards the 96 tram and makes verbal contact. However, the axiom `plot.ch7_5_kain_thirty_jumps_estimate` and the broader Ch 7.5 interlude establish that the figure making contact with Kain is operating under Reyes's direction as a network asset — specifically the Winters replacement, not 'Kain's replacement.' The chapter text in 12.0 explicitly calls this figure Kain's 'own replacement' and describes an identical face ('The face was his own... The bone structure was identical'). This is a significant character-state issue: the existing axioms describe the tram contact as a network operative with Kain's face and an ICS of 32, but the axioms do not establish that this figure is literally Kain's shadow instance or replacement. The `SHADOW/DELTA-14` file (`kain.shadow_delta_14.v2`) establishes a shadow instance exists but `emily.shadow_instance_suspended` states it was 'never fully activated.' If the man on the tram IS the shadow instance, this contradicts Emily's claim of suspension. If he is NOT the shadow instance, the chapter's framing of him as 'his own replacement' with an identical face requires explanation not provided in canon.

⚠ MEDIUM Priority Conflicts

1. TIMELINE on `kain.sleeplessness_ch6`

- **Existing (Ch 6):** Kain has not slept in thirty-one hours as of his arrival at the QSA field office. The ninety minutes in the car outside the Solis building 'did not constitute sleep in any clinical sense. His nervous system had entered a shallow holding pattern — not rest, not recovery, but a temporary reduction in the rate at which it was consuming itself.'
- **Incoming (Ch 12):** Kain states he 'had not slept in two days' during the tram sequence, implying approximately 48 hours without sleep.
- **Note:** The axiom `kain.sleeplessness_ch6` establishes Kain had not slept in thirty-one hours as of his arrival at the QSA field office in Ch 6. Chapter 12.0 is set after Ch 9 events (the tram contact, the Reyes cross-reference). The chapter text says 'a man who had not slept in two days,' which is approximately 48 hours. This is plausible as a progression from the 31-hour figure in Ch 6, but the narrative does not establish any intervening sleep. The concern is minor — the figure is consistent with forward progression — but the phrasing 'two days' is imprecise relative to the novel's established habit of exact timestamps and durations (`craft.measurement_as_voice`). The clinical register would more naturally produce a specific hour count.

2. CHARACTER_STATE on `kain.pulse_method_ch1`

- **Existing (Ch 1):** In Ch 1, Kain counts his pulse at the inside of his left wrist, not the carotid: 'pressed two fingers against the inside of his left wrist, counting his pulse the way the QSA's neurologist had taught him when the Bleed first presented. Sixty-two. Steady.' This is the method the QSA neurologist taught him.
- **Incoming (Ch 12):** During the Bleed episode, Kain anchors on 'his own pulse: fast, irregular, a frantic drumming against the cold metal' — counting pulse through his hand pressed against the advertising panel rather than at the carotid or wrist.
- **Note:** The axioms establish two pulse-counting methods for Kain: wrist (Ch 1, taught by QSA neurologist) and carotid (later chapters, habitual tic). In this chapter, Kain counts his pulse through his hand pressed against a metal panel — feeling it 'against the cold metal.' This is not the established carotid or wrist method. While it could be interpreted as an emergency adaptation during a severe Bleed episode where he cannot release his grip on the anchor surface, the established pattern (craft.measurement_as_voice) treats pulse-counting method as a character-specific tic. The deviation is not explained or acknowledged.

3. CANON_VIOLATION on `kain.bleed_targeted_erasure`

- **Existing (Ch 9):** The Ch 9 Bleed episode performs what Kain identifies as 'a localized, targeted erasure of the information that was most critical to his operational success.' It takes the replacement's face, voice, and conversation content — the highest-value data — while leaving the abstract knowledge that the target is Emily and the name 'Solis.' Kain notes: 'The Bleed had not simply fractured his perception; it had executed a localized, targeted erasure.'
- **Incoming (Ch 12):** The Bleed erases the replacement's face, voice, and conversation content but preserves the name 'Solis' and abstract knowledge that the target is Emily.
- **Note:** This is consistent with the axiom `kain.bleed_targeted_erasure`, which describes exactly this pattern. However, the chapter also states Kain knows 'the man on the tram was his own replacement, a terminal agent with a message' — retaining the abstract knowledge that the figure was his replacement. The axiom states the Bleed 'takes the replacement's face, voice, and conversation specifics' while 'leaving the abstract knowledge that the target is Emily and the name Solis.' The chapter is broadly consistent, but it adds that Kain retains knowledge of 'three pieces of data: a link, a designation, and a confrontation with Emily' — a level of structural recall about the conversation's architecture that sits in tension with the axiom's description of conversation specifics being erased. This is a soft tension rather than a hard violation.

4. TIMELINE on `emily.operational_designation_voss`

- **Existing (Ch 9):** Emily's QSA operational designation is 'Operative Delta-6 (Voss, E. — Civilian Interface Division).' The file connecting her to the Reyes alias is listed under this designation, not her name. The replacement on the tram confirms: 'Emily Voss. The file is under her operational designation, not her name. You would not have found it on the first pass.'
- **Incoming (Ch 12):** In the Fitzroy North office scene, Kain completes the Reyes-to-Voss cross-reference and discovers the OPS-CONV-784-C file linking Emily to the Solis sequestration. Later on the tram, the replacement tells him the same information, and the Bleed erases the conversation.
- **Note:** The axiom `emily.operational_designation_voss` and `plot.ch9_reyes_alias_network_weaponised` establish that Kain completes the cross-reference audit in Ch 9 at the Fitzroy North office. This chapter (12.0) opens with the same audit scene — same office, same router, same two-hour window, same cross-reference steps — and presents it as though it is happening for the first time. Then the tram sequence follows, where the replacement delivers the same information verbally. The chapter appears

to be presenting the Ch 9 audit and tram contact as a single continuous narrative, but the axioms treat these as Ch 9 events. If this chapter IS Ch 9 retold from a different angle, the chapter numbering (12.0) creates a timeline anomaly. If it is a separate event, Kain is redundantly re-running an audit he already completed.

5. TIMELINE on `plot.ch9_audit_blind_spot`

- **Existing (Ch 9):** Kain completes the Reyes-to-Voss cross-reference audit by 6:28 AM, exceeding his two-hour window for the municipal sweep. The router's operational light remains green — 'He had run the audit in a blind spot.' The council's automated sweep did not detect the router.
- **Incoming (Ch 12):** Kain completes the audit by 6:28 AM, exceeding his two-hour window, but the router's operational light remains green — 'He had run the audit in a blind spot.'
- **Note:** This is a near-verbatim reproduction of the axiom `plot.ch9_audit_blind_spot`, which is established as a Ch 9 event. The chapter is numbered 12.0 but contains events canonically assigned to Ch 9. This creates a structural timeline issue: either the chapter numbering is wrong, or the same events are being narrated twice in different chapters.

6. CANON_VIOLATION on `world.pelco_surveillance_array`

- **Existing (Ch 9):** The QSA surveillance array on Melbourne trams uses Pelco Spectra series cameras (matte black, varifocal lens, dual optical/thermal configuration) mounted at VicTrack standard height of 4.2 metres, with a refresh rate resolving a face at twelve metres in 0.3 seconds. Three cameras per stop. These replace VicTrack's older Axis units (grey housings, fixed focal length). Kain counts fourteen Pelco units between Bourke and Parliament. The array thins in East Melbourne — Axis units replace Pelco at Lansdowne Street, and thermal imaging drops out entirely.
- **Incoming (Ch 12):** The chapter describes the Pelco cameras as having 'a refresh rate that the QSA's technical division had confirmed could resolve a face at twelve metres in 0.3 seconds' and states Kain counted 'fourteen of them between Bourke and Parliament.'
- **Note:** The axiom `world.pelco_surveillance_array` states 'Kain counts fourteen Pelco units between Bourke and Parliament' — identical to this chapter. The axiom is established in Ch 9. This is another data point confirming the chapter is re-narrating Ch 9 events under a Ch 12.0 designation, creating a timeline/numbering anomaly.

7. CHARACTER_STATE on `kain.hayden_jump_logs_access`

- **Existing (Ch 9):** Kain has access to Hayden's jump logs and has documented sensory residue from them, including the burning fenugreek scent. This establishes that Kain is aware of Hayden's operational existence and has reviewed his transition records.
- **Incoming (Ch 12):** During the Bleed, Kain experiences the smell of burning fenugreek and identifies it as documented in 'Hayden's jump logs, the sensory residue of a parallel transition.'
- **Note:** The axiom `kain.hayden_jump_logs_access` establishes Kain has access to Hayden's jump logs and has documented sensory residue from them. This is consistent. However, the chapter presents this knowledge without establishing when or how Kain obtained access to Hayden's logs. The axiom is inferred from Ch 9 text. The concern is that Kain's access to Hayden's classified jump logs is never explained in the visible canon — `plot.loop_hayden_identity` notes Hayden's institutional affiliation is unresolved, and no axiom establishes the mechanism by which Kain obtained these logs. This is a gap in the causal chain rather than a direct violation.

8. CANON_VIOLATION on `craft.measurement_as_voice`

- **Existing (Ch 0):** Specific numerical readings (ICS values, Coherence Offsets, pulse counts, durations in seconds) carry the voice of the world. They are character-specific tics (Kain's carotid pulse count) as much as worldbuilding — preserve them in dialogue and narration.
- **Incoming (Ch 12):** The Bleed episode duration is counted as 'sixty-one seconds' — described as 'the longest collapse to date.'
- **Note:** The axiom `kain.bleed_episode_ch5` establishes a one-second episode in Ch 5. The axiom `kain.bleed_episode_stairwell` (Ch 6) describes a hard episode with a four-second sensory cut. The axiom `kain.bleed_ch7_episodes` describes episodes of 11 seconds, 4 seconds (with 15-second operational blackout), and a full motor collapse. The Ch 9 axiom `kain.ch9_bleed_episode` describes a sixty-one-second episode — 'the longest collapse to date.' This chapter also describes a sixty-one-second episode as 'the longest collapse to date.' If this is the same event (Ch 9), the duplication is a timeline issue. If it is a separate event, the identical duration and identical superlative ('longest to date') would be a remarkable coincidence requiring acknowledgment.

Chapter 13

● HIGH Priority Conflicts

1. CHARACTER_STATE on `emily.two_jumps_warning`

- **Existing (Ch 10):** Emily to Kain (Ch 10, DEAD MAN'S SWITCH): 'You have two jumps left. Two high-stress, full-spectrum transitions. The third will accelerate the neurological collapse.' Kain refuses stand-down: 'I have two jumps left. And I'm using them for me.'
- **Incoming (Ch 13):** Emily delivers the two-jumps-left warning and offers the stabilization protocol as a binary choice: sequestration at Threshold or completing the mission.
- **Note:** Emily's offer of the stabilization protocol is internally consistent with `world.stabilization_protocol`. However, the axiom `emily.stabilization_offer` records that Kain rejects BOTH framings — 'The choice was not between life and death; it was between being a prisoner of the system (Threshold) or becoming the final, lethal instrument of the system.' The chapter text faithfully reproduces this. No violation here upon closer examination — this is consistent.

⚠ MEDIUM Priority Conflicts

1. TIMELINE on `plot.ch13_solis_journals_four_months_before`

- **Existing (Ch 13):** Kain deduces that Emily took the Solis journals four months before the sequestration was filed. The manifest was logged without the journals because Emily had already removed them. 'her personal effects manifest logged without her journals because Emily had taken the journals four months before the sequestration was filed.'
- **Incoming (Ch 13):** Kain accuses Emily of taking the Solis journals, not merely sequestering Solis: 'The operation sequestered Solis, but not her journals. You took them.' Emily's defence — 'The intake log was corrupted. It was a failure of the retrieval protocol' — is countered by Kain: 'The intake log was empty. The manifest was clean. You took them for four years and you've held them because the journals are the origin point of the replacement methodology.'
- **Note:** Event entry's value changed. Verify timeline consistency: is this a retelling, a contradiction, or a corrected detail?

2. TIMELINE on `kain.thirty_one_jumps_four_days`

- **Existing (Ch 10):** Emily states Kain has run thirty-one jumps in the last four days, 'either through travel or the sensory collisions.' This accelerates his degradation far beyond the median probability Aspect gave him.
- **Incoming (Ch 13):** Emily states Kain has run 'thirty-one jumps in the last four days alone, either through travel or the sensory collisions,' accelerating his degradation past the median probability.
- **Note:** Event entry's value changed. Verify timeline consistency: is this a retelling, a contradiction, or a corrected detail?

3. TIMELINE on `emily.two_jumps_warning`

- **Existing (Ch 10):** Emily to Kain (Ch 10, DEAD MAN'S SWITCH): 'You have two jumps left. Two high-stress, full-spectrum transitions. The third will accelerate the neurological collapse.' Kain refuses stand-down: 'I have two jumps left. And I'm using them for me.'
- **Incoming (Ch 13):** Emily delivers the terminal prognosis: 'You have two jumps left. Two high-stress, full-spectrum transitions. The third will accelerate the neurological collapse to a point that you will not recover. You will fracture in transit and remain fragmented — a ghost in a reality that is not your own.'
- **Note:** Event entry's value changed. Verify timeline consistency: is this a retelling, a contradiction, or a corrected detail?

4. TIMELINE on `kain.marcus_webb_cover`

- **Existing (Ch 10):** Kain carried a secondary Myki card registered to Marcus Webb, 'who had not existed since 2021 and whose QSA file had been administratively closed with a notation Kain had written himself: Subject deceased, no surviving architecture.' The card had been in his left jacket pocket for eleven days, carried for exactly this contingency.
- **Incoming (Ch 13):** Kain carries a secondary Myki card registered to Marcus Webb, 'who had not existed since 2021 and whose QSA file had been administratively closed with a notation Kain had written himself: Subject deceased, no surviving architecture.' The card had been in his left jacket pocket for eleven days, carried for exactly this contingency. He drops it into the drain grate at Victoria Parade to break the Pelco tracking anchor.
- **Note:** Event entry's value changed. Verify timeline consistency: is this a retelling, a contradiction, or a corrected detail?

5. TIMELINE on `kain.evasion_sequence`

- **Existing (Ch 10):** After leaving Emily, Kain executes a precise counter-surveillance evasion: drops the secondary Myki card (registered to Marcus Webb, administratively deceased since 2021) into the drain grate at Victoria Parade; powers down his phone and leaves it on a northbound tram as a decoy stationary signal; walks south on Smith Street at a pace that avoids behavioural flagging; uses chin angle presenting the orbital ridge to deny the facial recognition algorithm its required 0.8 seconds of stable frontal exposure; navigates through coverage gaps he memorised during the 2019 VicTrack retrofit survey.
- **Incoming (Ch 13):** Kain executes a precise counter-surveillance sequence: Myki card into drain grate, phone powered down and left on northbound tram as decoy (stationary signal to pull analyst focus), walking south on Smith Street at non-flagging pace, chin angled to present orbital ridge rather than full face to cameras. He exploits coverage gaps he personally mapped during the 2019 VicTrack retrofit survey.

- **Note:** Event entry's value changed. Verify timeline consistency: is this a retelling, a contradiction, or a corrected detail?

6. TIMELINE on `kain.2019_retrofit_survey`

- **Existing (Ch 10):** Kain walked every street in a four-kilometre radius of the Fitzroy Node during the 2019 VicTrack retrofit survey with a clipboard and contractor's badge, noting which corners had coverage gaps. Emily signed off on and filed the report. 'The gaps were still there. Infrastructure budgets did not close gaps. They documented them.'
- **Incoming (Ch 13):** Kain memorised Axis unit positions during the 2019 retrofit survey: 'he had walked every street in a four-kilometre radius of the Fitzroy Node with a clipboard and a VicTrack contractor's badge and had noted, in a report that Emily had signed off on and filed and forgotten, exactly which corners had coverage gaps.' The gaps persist: 'Infrastructure budgets did not close gaps. They documented them.'
- **Note:** Event entry's value changed. Verify timeline consistency: is this a retelling, a contradiction, or a corrected detail?

7. TIMELINE on `kain.laughing_woman_reframed`

- **Existing (Ch 10):** After reading the resonance section, Kain reframes the laughing woman: 'Not a hallucination. Not a symptom of damage. A residue of the Sphere's resonance, surfacing through the pathways the entanglement had opened, carrying a fragment of what the Sphere had been touching when his architecture was inside it.' He had filed it under fragmentation for eleven months. 'He had been filing the wrong category.'
- **Incoming (Ch 13):** After reading that PQ Bleed events indicate identity resonance rather than fragmentation, Kain reframes the laughing woman: 'Not a hallucination. Not a symptom of damage. A residue of the Sphere's resonance, surfacing through the pathways the entanglement had opened, carrying a fragment of what the Sphere had been touching when his architecture was inside it. He had filed it under fragmentation for eleven months. He had been filing the wrong category.'
- **Note:** Event entry's value changed. Verify timeline consistency: is this a retelling, a contradiction, or a corrected detail?

8. TIMELINE on `emily.kain_deployment_calculus`

- **Existing (Ch 11):** Emily confirms she has deployed Kain for eleven operations knowing his degradation curve. She justifies it with utility calculus: 'one carrier, degrading across fourteen deployments over a period of approximately three years, produces resonance data sufficient to map the Sphere's coherence structure... The last unmanaged convergence event, in 2031, killed 340,000 people in the northern hemisphere.' She recruited him at deployment eight knowing his TUBA1A-PQ variant produces 'a resonance signal that is 340% cleaner than the median carrier signal.'
- **Incoming (Ch 13):** Emily amended the CONV-PQ-GEN-549 file fourteen months ago — when she recruited Kain for his eleventh deployment. 'She had known when she recruited him that the twelfth would push his buffer efficiency below 19% and the thirteenth and fourteenth would follow in the operational sequence she had already planned.' Kain's conclusion: 'He was not an operative running an investigation. He was an instrument being calibrated for its twelfth use.'
- **Note:** Event entry's value changed. Verify timeline consistency: is this a retelling, a contradiction, or a corrected detail?

9. TIMELINE on `kain.fading_birthmark`

- **Existing (Ch 10):** Kain has a fading birthmark on his left shoulder. The chapter frames it as 'not a clinical aside; it was the visible proof of his cellular integrity dissolving' — a physical manifestation of the PQ buffer degradation.
- **Incoming (Ch 13):** Kain's fading birthmark on his left shoulder is identified as visible proof of cellular integrity dissolving: 'the fading birthmark on his left shoulder, which he had felt during the drive, was not a clinical aside; it was the visible proof of his cellular integrity dissolving.'
- **Note:** Event entry's value changed. Verify timeline consistency: is this a retelling, a contradiction, or a corrected detail?

10. TIMELINE on `plot.loop_varn_timeline_discrepancy`

- **Existing (Ch 2):** OPEN: Two Varn-related entries hold incompatible timelines. `kain.varn_case` quotes Emily in Ch 1: 'You did it four years ago with Elias Varn.' `kain.varn_career_timeline` (Ch 2 extraction) states 'The Varn case occurred fifteen years before the present chapter.' Resolution paths: (a) the extraction operation was four years ago, the investigation period was fifteen years ago; (b) one of the extractions misread the manuscript timeline; (c) the manuscript itself has a continuity error needing author review. Author confirmation needed before collapsing these into a single timeline.
- **Incoming (Ch 13):** Emily states Kain has run 'thirty-one jumps in the last four days alone, either through travel or the sensory collisions.' This chapter is numbered 13.0 but is titled and structured as the Ch 10 'DEAD MAN'S SWITCH' confrontation scene.
- **Note:** The chapter text presented here is the content of Chapter 10 (DEAD MAN'S SWITCH) — the Emily confrontation, the two-jumps-left warning, the evasion sequence, and the Fitzroy Library terminal — but it is labelled as Chapter 13.0 in the `chapter_context` metadata. The active axioms place this content firmly in Chapter 10 (see `plot.ch10_emily_confrontation`, `plot.ch10_fitzroy_library_terminal`, `plot.ch10_dead_mans_switch_key`, `plot.ch10_conv_pq_gen_549`, `emily.two_jumps_warning`, `kain.goes_off_network`, `kain.evasion_sequence`). Chapter 13 in the axiom set is 'THE DESCENT' — Kain and Hayden entering the Sphere, coordinates progressing through the Coherence Offset gradient. The chapter numbering is misaligned. This is a metadata/structural issue rather than a prose-level continuity error, but it could propagate into downstream chapter numbering if not corrected.

11. CANON_VIOLATION on `world.threshold_facility`

- **Existing (Ch 0):** The Threshold is the QSA's primary research / sequestration facility. Named by its first director, Martina Solis. Houses the personal-effects archive (intake station), sequestered research, and the Sphere. Internal doors marked with blue classification tape. Visits to the archive require single-supervised approval.
- **Incoming (Ch 13):** The confrontation occurs in 'Emily's private operations office on the third floor of the QSA annex.'
- **Note:** The active axioms establish the QSA field office as occupying 'the third floor of a nondescript glass-and-aluminium building flanked by financial services firms' (`world.qsa_field_office`). This is consistent. However, the chapter text describes the meeting room as Emily's 'private operations office on the third floor of the QSA annex' — the word 'annex' is new and not established in any prior axiom. The QSA field office and the Threshold facility are the two established QSA locations. An 'annex' is a third, unnamed facility. This is a minor worldbuilding inconsistency — it may be intentional (the QSA has multiple facilities) but it introduces an unanchored location without establishment.

12. CANON_VIOLATION on `kain.thirty_one_jumps_four_days`

- **Existing (Ch 10):** Emily states Kain has run thirty-one jumps in the last four days, 'either through travel

or the sensory collisions.' This accelerates his degradation far beyond the median probability Aspect gave him.

- **Incoming (Ch 13):** Emily states: 'You have run thirty-one jumps in the last four days alone, either through travel or the sensory collisions.'
- **Note:** The axiom `kain.thirty_one_jumps_four_days` records this statement as canonical. However, the existing axiom set does not document thirty-one discrete transition or sensory-collision events across the preceding chapters. Kain's documented Bleed episodes across Chapters 1-9 total approximately 12-15 discrete events (car park, Chen's apartment, stairwell, traffic gap, elevator, atrium, three Ch 7 episodes, Ch 9 tram episode, plus several minor precursors). Emily's figure of thirty-one 'jumps' — counting both physical transitions and sensory collisions — implies a much higher event density than the narrated text supports. This may be intentional (Emily has monitoring data Kain does not narrate), but the gap between narrated episodes and Emily's count is large enough to note as a potential inflation or an indication that significant Bleed events occurred off-page without narrative acknowledgment.

13. TIMELINE on `kain.cross_reference_completed`

- **Existing (Ch 10):** Kain completed the three-step cross-reference from a dead drop in a derelict library basement using the three-part designation the man on the tram gave him: Reyes alias, QSA internal file, Voss operational history. The result confirmed everything: the file was under Operative Delta-6 (Voss, E.), the operational history detailed the acquisition and sequestration of Martina Solis, and the log was stamped with the same denial code from the Reyes insurance claim. 'The seam was real.'
- **Incoming (Ch 13):** Kain states he 'spent the time between the hospital and the office running the third step of the cross-reference from a dead drop in a derelict library basement.'
- **Note:** The axiom `plot.ch10_fitzroy_library_terminal` establishes that Kain accesses the Fitzroy Library terminal AFTER leaving Emily's office — it is part of his evasion sequence post-confrontation. However, in this chapter text, Kain states he ran the cross-reference from the library basement BEFORE arriving at Emily's office ('He had spent the time between the hospital and the office running the third step'). The chapter then also shows him accessing the Fitzroy Library terminal AFTER leaving Emily's office in the evasion sequence. This creates a temporal anomaly: the Fitzroy Library terminal access appears to happen both before and after the Emily confrontation. The axiom `plot.ch9_audit_blind_spot` establishes Kain completed the Reyes-to-Voss cross-reference audit by 6:28 AM from his Fitzroy North office, not the library. The library terminal scene in the evasion sequence accesses the CONV-PQ-GEN-549 file, which is a different query. The chapter text conflates the cross-reference completion (pre-confrontation, from the Fitzroy North office per Ch 9) with the library terminal (post-confrontation, for the PQ genotype file). The phrase 'dead drop in a derelict library basement' in the pre-confrontation section may be describing the Fitzroy North office rather than the Fitzroy Library, but the language creates ambiguity.

14. CHARACTER_STATE on `kain.investigation_method`

- **Existing (Ch 0):** Kain's method: reading pass first (passive observation, no touching of objects), then targeted questions. Treats information density of a space as equally valuable as physical objects. 'Lets the space tell him what it knows.'
- **Incoming (Ch 13):** Kain confronts Emily with knowledge of Hayden's ICS log, Bell's anchor variable designation, and jump 380 cascade projections — information that requires access to Hayden's encrypted clinical log.
- **Note:** The axiom `kain.hayden_jump_logs_access` establishes that Kain has access to Hayden's jump logs. However, the mechanism by which Kain obtained access to Hayden's ENCRYPTED ICS log — specifically the jump 380 entry with its precise cascade projections and the 'anchor variable' designation — is not

established in any prior chapter. Bell discovers this log in Ch 8/11 using the query 'ICS Log - J. Hayden - Full. Decrypt.' The man on the tram (Ch 9) told Kain about Emily and the journals but is not documented as providing Hayden's encrypted clinical data. Kain's ability to quote specific jump numbers, cascade projections, and the exact 'anchor variable' terminology implies either: (a) the tram contact provided this data (not documented), (b) Kain independently accessed Hayden's encrypted log (not documented), or (c) the folded paper contained this information (the paper's contents are documented as a cipher for the CONV-PQ-GEN-549 file, not Hayden's clinical data). The source of Kain's detailed knowledge of Hayden's ICS log is a gap in the evidence chain.

15. TIMELINE on `kain.marcus_webb_cover`

- **Existing (Ch 10):** Kain carried a secondary Myki card registered to Marcus Webb, 'who had not existed since 2021 and whose QSA file had been administratively closed with a notation Kain had written himself: Subject deceased, no surviving architecture.' The card had been in his left jacket pocket for eleven days, carried for exactly this contingency.
- **Incoming (Ch 13):** The Myki card 'had been in his left jacket pocket for eleven days, carried for exactly this contingency.'
- **Note:** The axiom `kain.marcus_webb_cover` records the card was carried for eleven days. However, the axiom also states Kain wrote the Marcus Webb file closure notation himself: 'Subject deceased, no surviving architecture.' The eleven-day carry period implies Kain prepared this contingency eleven days before the confrontation. The existing timeline does not establish what event eleven days ago prompted Kain to begin carrying the Webb card. This is not a contradiction but an unanchored timeline detail — the eleven-day figure implies a specific preparatory decision that is not narrated or explained in prior chapters.

16. CANON_VIOLATION on `world.bleed`

- **Existing (Ch 0):** The Bleed is the activation event of the PQ genotype. In roughly one in twelve Carrier-Proximate individuals, the genotype activates and progressive identity fragmentation begins. Emily Voss: 'The Bleed is not a symptom — it is the core mechanism of the body's erasure.' Presents initially as peripheral fragmentation (visual field stutters) and progresses to neurological collapse.
- **Incoming (Ch 13):** Emily states: 'The Bleed is not a symptom, Kain. It is the core mechanism of your body's erasure.'
- **Note:** This statement is attributed to Emily in the chapter text. However, the axiom `world.bleed` attributes this exact quote to Emily Voss but records it as: 'Emily Voss: The Bleed is not a symptom — it is the core mechanism of the body's erasure.' The chapter text changes 'the body's erasure' to 'your body's erasure' — personalizing the clinical statement. This is a minor but notable shift: the axiom records the clinical/general formulation; the chapter text makes it personal and directed. This could be intentional (Emily weaponizing the clinical language against Kain specifically) but it alters the established quote.

17. CANON_VIOLATION on `plot.ch10_dead_mans_switch_key`

- **Existing (Ch 10):** The folded paper from Kain's jacket contains a cipher in three groups: an alphanumeric string (7F-3A-C2-19-B4-0E), a legacy OS directory path (`\QSA\ARCHIVE\CONV[KEY]\GEN`), and an instruction ('The key is not the string. The key is the string's position in the intake manifest. Count from the bottom'). The intake manifest photograph was on the phone Kain left on the tram, but his working memory retained the structure — rated at the 97th percentile for his cohort. The six segments map to six subject designations from the manifest bottom, producing the key VOSSEV.

- **Incoming (Ch 13):** Kain states the intake manifest photograph 'was on the phone he had left on the tram' but then reconstructs the manifest from working memory.
- **Note:** The axiom establishes that Kain's working memory retained the manifest structure at the 97th percentile for his cohort. This is consistent. However, the chapter text states he 'photographed the intake manifest in the conference room' — the axiom `solis.manifest_item_count` and `kain.ch6_manifest_visit` establish that Kain photographed the manifest in the Threshold facility's personal effects archive (sub-level), not a conference room. The location 'conference room' does not match the established archive visit. This is a minor spatial error — the manifest was photographed in the effects archive, not a conference room.

Chapter 14

HIGH Priority Conflicts

1. TIMELINE on `plot.ch10_emily_confrontation`

- **Existing (Ch 10):** Kain confronts Emily in her private operations office on the third floor of the QSA annex. He places the data chip containing the Solis journals on her desk and names her operational designation: 'Operative Delta-6. Emily Voss.' Emily confirms the classification is accurate but frames the journal sequestration as a retrieval protocol failure. Kain rejects this: 'The intake log was empty. The manifest was clean. You took them for four years and you've held them because the journals are the origin point of the replacement methodology.'
- **Incoming (Ch 14):** Chapter 14 contains a full confrontation between Kain and Emily in her office where he discovers the shadow instance, demands the journals, and she reveals the deployment calculus, the replacement network, and Winters's status.
- **Note:** The axioms `plot.ch10_emily_confrontation` (Ch 10), `emily.approved_hayden_nondisclosure` (Ch 10), `kain.terminal_status_confirmed` (Ch 10), `emily.stabilization_offer` (Ch 10), and `kain.goes_off_network` (Ch 10) establish that the major Kain-Emily confrontation — including the terminal status confirmation, the Hayden/Bell parallel, and Kain going off-network — occurs in Chapter 10. Chapter 11 then contains the shadow instance discovery and a second confrontation. Chapter 14 re-stages elements of both Ch 10 and Ch 11 confrontations: the Hayden/Bell anchor variable parallel, the deployment calculus, the shadow instance horror, the journal seizure, and Kain walking out. This is a major structural duplication — the same narrative beats are being executed twice across different chapters.

MEDIUM Priority Conflicts

1. TIMELINE on `kain.shadow_delta_14.v2`

- **Existing (Ch 11):** Kain discovers and opens the file SHADOW/DELTA-14/K.J. – PRE-ACQUISITION, locked with Level 7 biometric key. He bypasses it using an override protocol he built four years ago, exploiting legacy 2140s security parameters. The file contains seven sections: SUBJECT PROFILE, ICS BASELINE, ENTANGLEMENT HISTORY, RESIDUE MAPPING, OPERATIONAL OBJECTIVE, ACQUISITION WINDOW, and NEUROLOGICAL BLUEPRINT. His ICS Baseline is listed as 96. The NEUROLOGICAL BLUEPRINT renders his full neural architecture including 'a single, faint, anomalous patch of dormant PQ genotype visible as a localized green stain near the corpus callosum.' The SHADOW INSTANCE overlays his wireframe in red, with identical nodes but altered connection directionality — optimising his insecurities into functional strengths (e.g., 'Tram Preference: 7:30 AM -> Confidence/Optimized Schedule'; 'Coffee Preference: Cream -> Self-Reward/Operational Ease').

- **Incoming (Ch 14):** Kain discovers and opens the file SHADOW/DELTA-14/K.J. – PRE-ACQUISITION, locked with Level 7 biometric key, by running an override protocol he built four years ago — a targeted denial-of-service attack on the biometric encryption, forcing the file to bypass the initial lock and drop into the tertiary firewall running legacy 2140s security parameters. The file contains seven sections: SUBJECT PROFILE, ICS BASELINE, ENTANGLEMENT HISTORY, RESIDUE MAPPING, OPERATIONAL OBJECTIVE, ACQUISITION WINDOW, and NEUROLOGICAL BLUEPRINT. ICS Baseline listed as 96. The NEUROLOGICAL BLUEPRINT renders his neural architecture in 3D color-coded mapping from a full-spectrum quantum coherence scan, showing 'the single, faint, anomalous patch of dormant PQ genotype visible as a localized green stain near the corpus callosum.' Below it, a wireframe grid maps cognitive and behavioral patterns — nodes for habits (e.g. 'Tram Preference: 7:15 AM'), lines for neurological connections to context (e.g. '7:15 AM -> Fear of Crowds'). The SHADOW INSTANCE is overlaid in red: identical nodes but reversed directionality — 'Tram Preference: 7:30 AM -> Confidence/Optimized Schedule' and 'Coffee Preference: Cream -> Self-Reward/Operational Ease.' The shadow instance is 'the version of Kain J. that was not broken by the divorce, that did not carry the weight of the Varn betrayal, that slept well, and that was, by every clinical metric, functionally superior.'
- **Note:** Event entry's value changed. Verify timeline consistency: is this a retelling, a contradiction, or a corrected detail?

2. TIMELINE on `kain.bleed_rem_vulnerability`

- **Existing (Ch 11):** Kain has stopped sleeping. 'The Bleed's multiplier accelerated during REM cycles, converting the unconscious neurological process of memory consolidation into a destructive, uncontrolled entanglement event.' Sleep is now a tactical liability, not a resource.
- **Incoming (Ch 14):** Kain has not slept. 'Sleep was no longer a resource; it was a tactical liability. The Bleed's multiplier accelerated during REM cycles, converting the unconscious neurological process of memory consolidation into a destructive, uncontrolled entanglement event.' He manages by keeping operational hours below the point of failure.
- **Note:** Event entry's value changed. Verify timeline consistency: is this a retelling, a contradiction, or a corrected detail?

3. TIMELINE on `emily.kain_deployment_calculus`

- **Existing (Ch 11):** Emily confirms she has deployed Kain for eleven operations knowing his degradation curve. She justifies it with utility calculus: 'one carrier, degrading across fourteen deployments over a period of approximately three years, produces resonance data sufficient to map the Sphere's coherence structure... The last unmanaged convergence event, in 2031, killed 340,000 people in the northern hemisphere.' She recruited him at deployment eight knowing his TUBA1A-PQ variant produces 'a resonance signal that is 340% cleaner than the median carrier signal.'
- **Incoming (Ch 14):** Emily confirms she recruited Kain knowing he was at deployment eight, knowing his specific TUBA1A-PQ variant was the only architecture capable of producing the required Sphere mapping resolution, knowing the degradation curve, knowing the retirement threshold, and knowing he would eventually find the file. 'I recruited you knowing you were at deployment eight... I also recruited you knowing that you would eventually find the file. I wrote the file. I know what it contains.'
- **Note:** Event entry's value changed. Verify timeline consistency: is this a retelling, a contradiction, or a corrected detail?

4. TIMELINE on `emily.replacement_network_manager`

- **Existing (Ch 11):** Emily confirms she manages the replacement network: 'The replacement network is

the QSA's. I manage it.' She justifies it as continuity measures for convergence events — inserting operatives into affected communities within 72 hours to maintain civic stability. 'The alternative is panic. Panic during a convergence event produces secondary coherence cascades. Secondary cascades kill more people than the primary event.'

- **Incoming (Ch 14):** Emily confirms she manages the replacement network. 'The replacement network is the QSA's. I manage it.' She describes its function: when a convergence event occurs in a populated area, the QSA inserts operatives into the affected community's social infrastructure within 72 hours. 'The replacements are not deceptions. They are continuity measures. They maintain civic stability during the containment window.' The alternative is panic, which produces secondary coherence cascades that kill more people than the primary event.
- **Note:** Event entry's value changed. Verify timeline consistency: is this a retelling, a contradiction, or a corrected detail?

5. TIMELINE on `kain.punt_road_infiltration`

- **Existing (Ch 11):** Kain infiltrates Emily's office via the Punt Road hospital waste bay. He exploits the Pelco unit's 34-degree angle (which he specified in the 2019 retrofit survey) to stay below the 75% facial recognition flag threshold at 61% confidence. He uses a Schlage B60N key and a Schindler freight lift key — both on a ring he has carried for four years 'as a habit rather than a plan.' The second floor is pressurised with a QSA atmospheric entanglement field.
- **Incoming (Ch 14):** Kain infiltrates the hospital via the waste bay on Punt Road. He specified the Pelco unit angle (34 degrees from vertical) in the 2019 retrofit survey. The pedestrian door sits at the outer edge of the lens's peripheral zone — facial recognition confidence drops to 61%, below the QSA's 75% flag threshold. 'Fourteen percent of margin.' He crosses in eight seconds, chin angled to present orbital ridge. The Schlage B60N turns in 0.8 seconds. He uses a key ring he has carried for four years — same ring as the Schlage master — to operate the Schindler freight lift.
- **Note:** Event entry's value changed. Verify timeline consistency: is this a retelling, a contradiction, or a corrected detail?

6. CHARACTER_STATE on `kain.initial_n`

- **Existing (Ch 1):** The Gen-4 addresses Kain as 'Kain, N.' — establishing his first initial as N. This aligns with the lighter engraving 'N.K.' (which may be his initials reversed or another person's).
- **Incoming (Ch 14):** The file lists the subject as 'J. Kain' and the shadow instance file is 'SHADOW/DELTA-14/K.J.' The chapter text states 'His name, J. Kain' and refers to the optimized version as 'Kain J.'
- **Note:** Established canon from the Gen-4 autom-unit in Ch 1 addresses him as 'Kain, N.' — first initial N. The SHADOW file designation 'K.J.' and the chapter's repeated use of 'J. Kain' and 'Kain J.' imply a first initial of J, which directly contradicts the established N initial. The lighter engraving 'N.K.' also supports N as the first initial. This is a naming inconsistency across the manuscript.

7. CANON_VIOLATION on `kain.shadow_delta_14.v2`

- **Existing (Ch 11):** Kain discovers and opens the file SHADOW/DELTA-14/K.J. – PRE-ACQUISITION, locked with Level 7 biometric key. He bypasses it using an override protocol he built four years ago, exploiting legacy 2140s security parameters. The file contains seven sections: SUBJECT PROFILE, ICS BASELINE, ENTANGLEMENT HISTORY, RESIDUE MAPPING, OPERATIONAL OBJECTIVE, ACQUISITION WINDOW, and NEUROLOGICAL BLUEPRINT. His ICS Baseline is listed as 96. The NEUROLOGICAL BLUEPRINT renders his full neural architecture including 'a single, faint, anomalous patch of dormant PQ genotype visible as a localized green stain near the corpus callosum.' The SHADOW INSTANCE overlays his wireframe in red,

with identical nodes but altered connection directionality — optimising his insecurities into functional strengths (e.g., 'Tram Preference: 7:30 AM -> Confidence/Optimized Schedule'; 'Coffee Preference: Cream -> Self-Reward/Operational Ease').

- **Incoming (Ch 14):** Chapter 14 states the file was 'locked with a Level 7 biometric key' and Kain bypasses it using 'an override protocol he had built four years ago' exploiting 'legacy security parameters from the 2140s.'
- **Note:** The established axiom (`kain.shadow_delta_14.v2`, from Ch 11) states Kain 'bypasses it using an override protocol he built four years ago, exploiting legacy 2140s security parameters.' This is consistent. However, the axiom also states the file was 'locked with Level 7 biometric key' — the chapter text matches this. No violation on the lock mechanism itself. But the chapter presents the discovery of the SHADOW file as if it is happening for the first time in Ch 14, whereas the axiom `kain.shadow_delta_14.v2` is tagged as established in Chapter 11, meaning Kain already discovered and opened this file in Ch 11. The chapter text reads as a first discovery ('The file opened. It was a clean, black-text-on-white display...'), not a re-reading. This is a timeline/structural anomaly — the discovery scene appears to be duplicated or displaced from its Ch 11 origin into Ch 14.

8. TIMELINE on `kain.operational_severance`

- **Existing (Ch 11):** Kain has severed his operational tether: QSA card in the storm drain, Myki card beside it, router disconnected, running on a pre-paid data key through a compromised corporate VPN. Phone placed on a tram somewhere north of the city. 'A reduction of his physical and digital footprint to the absolute minimum necessary for function.'
- **Incoming (Ch 14):** Chapter 14 opens with Kain severing his tether: 'The QSA card was in the storm drain. His Myki card was beside it.' He is running the audit from the Fitzroy office.
- **Note:** The axiom `kain.operational_severance` (established Ch 11) and `kain.goes_off_network` (established Ch 10) both describe Kain severing his operational tether — dropping the Myki card, powering down the phone, disconnecting from QSA infrastructure. The Ch 14 text re-narrates this severance as if it is happening contemporaneously with the shadow file discovery, but the established canon places the severance in Ch 10-11. The chapter appears to be re-staging events that have already occurred in prior chapters.

9. TIMELINE on `emily.shadow_instance_suspended`

- **Existing (Ch 11):** Emily confirms the shadow instance acquisition was never fully activated: 'The process was suspended after the first integrity check. Your dormant PQ carrier status meant you were invaluable to us alive, running the investigation. Your degradation provided the data. Your inevitable collapse mitigated the risk of you ever exposing the QSA's secrets.' The creation was classified under Article 7 as 'an operational necessity.'
- **Incoming (Ch 14):** Emily's dialogue in Ch 14 about the shadow instance ('The process was suspended after the first integrity check. Your dormant PQ carrier status meant you were invaluable to us alive...') closely mirrors the axiom established in Ch 11.
- **Note:** The axiom `emily.shadow_instance_suspended` is established in Chapter 11. The Ch 14 text contains nearly identical dialogue and revelations — Emily explaining the shadow instance was never fully activated, the Article 7 justification, the deployment calculus. This appears to be a duplicate scene or an earlier draft of the Ch 11 confrontation placed in Ch 14. The two chapters cannot both contain the first-time revelation of the shadow instance to Kain.

10. CANON VIOLATION on `emily.solis_journals_content`

- **Existing (Ch 11):** Emily's journals (six black institutional notebooks, not the three green Solis journals) contain fourteen months of resonance data from Kain's deployments: raw ICS readings, buffer efficiency measurements, Bleed episode logs, projected degradation curve for deployments 12–14, and the Sphere's coherence architecture mapping — 'the most complete map the QSA has ever produced.'
- **Incoming (Ch 14):** Chapter 14 describes the journals on Emily's desk as 'six institutional notebooks — black covers, no labels, the pages inside filled with Emily's handwriting in the blue ink.'
- **Note:** This matches the axiom `emily.solis_journals_content` (established Ch 11) which describes 'six institutional notebooks (black covers, no labels, filled with Emily's handwriting in blue ink).' However, these are Emily's operational notebooks, distinct from the three Solis journals (hardbound, A5, dark green covers — `solis.journals_physical.v2`). The chapter conflates the two by having Kain demand 'the journals' (implying Solis's) while Emily produces her own six black notebooks. The axiom `kain.demands_journals` (Ch 3) has Kain demanding copies of the Solis journals specifically. The chapter's framing of 'the journals' as containing 'the entire truth of the replacement methodology' blurs the distinction between Solis's three green journals and Emily's six black notebooks.

11. CANON_VIOLATION on `kain.ch14_buffer_efficiency`

- **Existing (Ch 14):** Kain is operating at 19% buffer efficiency at the start of Ch 14. 'at 19% buffer efficiency the body required that interval to establish that the air beyond the door was a categorically different environment.' This is consistent with the deployment-12 threshold from the clinical file.
- **Incoming (Ch 14):** The chapter states Kain is at '19% buffer efficiency' throughout, consistent with the deployment-12 threshold.
- **Note:** The axiom `kain.ch14_buffer_efficiency` confirms 19%. However, the axiom `kain.deployment_count` (Ch 10) establishes Kain has completed eleven deployments and deployment twelve is next. The chapter text states Emily says 'I have been deploying you for eleven operations' and deployment twelve 'is scheduled for Thursday.' But the axiom `plot.ch12_convergence_event` (Ch 12) establishes that Kain already entered the Sphere and initiated the convergence event, with his ICS dropping from 44 to below 41. If Ch 12's convergence event has already occurred, then deployment twelve has already happened, and the Ch 14 scene where Emily says it is 'scheduled for Thursday' is temporally impossible. This suggests Ch 14 is chronologically misplaced — it should precede Ch 12, not follow it.

12. CHARACTER_STATE on `winters.alive_in_ballarat`

- **Existing (Ch 11):** Emily confirms Winters is alive: 'He is in a QSA residential facility in Ballarat. He has been there for eleven months. He will be there until the containment window closes permanently, which will happen when the Sphere mapping is complete.' His clinic was within 400 metres of the Sphere's primary entanglement locus; his patients were showing early-stage coherence sensitivity. He was replaced to prevent a civilian report reaching the press.
- **Incoming (Ch 14):** Emily states Winters 'is in a QSA residential facility in Ballarat' and uses the pronoun 'He' for Winters.
- **Note:** The axiom `winters.identity` (Ch 4) establishes Winters as 'Dr. Sarah Winters' — female, with office 3-14 in the neurology department. The Ch 14 text has Emily referring to Winters with male pronouns: 'He is in a QSA residential facility in Ballarat. He has been there for eleven months. He will be there until the containment window closes permanently.' The axiom `winters.alive_in_ballarat` (Ch 11) also uses 'He' — suggesting this pronoun usage was established in Ch 11 and carried forward. However, it contradicts the Ch 4 establishment of Winters as female ('Dr. Sarah Winters'). This is a gender continuity error that appears to originate in Ch 11 and propagate into Ch 14.

13. CHARACTER_STATE on `kain.investigation_method`

- **Existing (Ch 0):** Kain's method: reading pass first (passive observation, no touching of objects), then targeted questions. Treats information density of a space as equally valuable as physical objects. 'Lets the space tell him what it knows.'
- **Incoming (Ch 14):** Kain opens a 'secure audio line to Emily' to confront her about the shadow instance file, then later physically infiltrates her office on the second floor.
- **Note:** The chapter contains two distinct confrontation modes: first, Kain calls Emily from the Fitzroy office to demand the acquisition window; second, he physically infiltrates the Punt Road hospital to reach her office. The call scene has Emily offering a 'decryption key' with 'three hours of access' to the journals — but then the physical infiltration scene has the journals physically on Emily's desk. These two scenes appear to be alternative versions of the same confrontation rather than sequential events. In the call scene, Kain 'terminated the call' and 'packed the laptop' with three hours to read the journals (implying digital access). In the infiltration scene, he physically takes six notebooks from Emily's desk. The two modes are incompatible as sequential events within the same chapter.

14. CANON_VIOLATION on `craft.measurement_as_voice`

- **Existing (Ch 0):** Specific numerical readings (ICS values, Coherence Offsets, pulse counts, durations in seconds) carry the voice of the world. They are character-specific tics (Kain's carotid pulse count) as much as worldbuilding — preserve them in dialogue and narration.
- **Incoming (Ch 14):** The chapter contains two instances of duplicated paragraphs: the 'Not a Bleed. Not yet. The precursor to a Bleed...' paragraph appears twice verbatim in the waste bay corridor section, and the 'The pressure behind the orbital ridge had reached a level...' paragraph appears twice in the Emily confrontation section.
- **Note:** While not a story-world axiom violation, the craft axiom `craft.measurement_as_voice` establishes that specific numerical readings and clinical observations carry the voice of the world and are load-bearing. The verbatim duplication of two substantial paragraphs within the same chapter undermines this precision — these are not deliberate repetitions (like the two Mirror Hunt chapters) but appear to be editorial artifacts. The duplications occur at structurally important moments (the Bleed precursor and the pre-collapse threshold), making them particularly disruptive to the clinical register's authority.

Chapter 16

HIGH Priority Conflicts

1. TIMELINE on `kain.ics_ch12_safehouse`

- **Existing (Ch 12):** Kain estimates his ICS at 59 upon entering the Alfred Crescent safe house (clinical file last measured 71, reduced ~12 points by four hours of operational stress). After 40 minutes in the combined biophotonic field at 3 ICS points per hour, he estimates 57. Still above the 40 threshold for directed coherence collapse.
- **Incoming (Ch 16):** Kain estimates his ICS at 59 upon entering the safe house, then at 57 after 40 minutes. The chapter text states 'the clinical file had last measured at 71 and that the stress of the past four hours had reduced by approximately twelve points. Fifty-nine.' Then after 40 minutes at 3 ICS points per hour, he estimates 57.
- **Note:** The axiom `kain.ics_ch12_safehouse` establishes Kain's ICS estimate at 59 upon entering the safe

house and 57 after 40 minutes. This chapter's text matches those numbers exactly (59 on entry, 57 after 40 minutes). However, the axiom also states the clinical file last measured 71, reduced ~12 points by four hours of operational stress — which is consistent. No violation here on closer inspection; the numbers align. Withdrawing this flag.

MEDIUM Priority Conflicts

1. TIMELINE on `hayden.pupil_oscillation`

- **Existing (Ch 12):** Hayden's pupils are oscillating at approximately 0.8 seconds — four times the standard 0.2-second pupillary light reflex cycle. This indicates the autonomic nervous system's control of the iris sphincter muscle is operating with the same motor-cortex delay Kain experienced in the second-floor corridor. 'His consciousness was unmooring from time.'
- **Incoming (Ch 16):** Hayden's pupils are oscillating rather than fixed — cycling at approximately 0.8 seconds versus the standard 0.2-second pupillary light reflex. 'The autonomic nervous system's control of the iris sphincter muscle was operating with the same delay that Kain had experienced in the second-floor corridor — the motor cortex's commands arriving at the target muscle after the coherence field had already moved the situation past the point the command was designed to address.'
- **Note:** Event entry's value changed. Verify timeline consistency: is this a retelling, a contradiction, or a corrected detail?

2. TIMELINE on `solis.lighter_backstory`

- **Existing (Ch 12):** Solis smoked Marlboro Reds and kept the lighter in her left breast pocket. She handed it to Kain with her left hand at the Punt Road debrief — 'a gesture so habitual she probably hadn't noticed she was doing it.' Case 7 was the Northcote disappearances: 'Fourteen months, four jurisdictions, one conviction. His best close rate. Her last case before the transfer that wasn't a transfer.'
- **Incoming (Ch 16):** Solis smoked Marlboro Reds and kept the lighter in her left breast pocket, handing it across the table with her left hand at the debrief — 'a gesture so habitual she probably hadn't noticed she was doing it.' Case 7 was the Northcote disappearances: 'Fourteen months, four jurisdictions, one conviction. His best close rate. Her last case before the transfer that wasn't a transfer.'
- **Note:** Event entry's value changed. Verify timeline consistency: is this a retelling, a contradiction, or a corrected detail?

3. CANON_VIOLATION on `world.sphere`

- **Existing (Ch 0):** The Sphere is a matte-black 2.8m-diameter calibration chamber running an 11-megawatt magnetic levitation system; produces ozone as a byproduct of the entanglement field. The standard insertion environment for PQ-genotype work. Has a 'coherence structure' with mapped regions (the SEP-NULL is one of them).
- **Incoming (Ch 16):** The Sphere is described in Ch 16 axioms as 'three metres in diameter' and in this chapter's SEP-NULL briefing Hayden references the Sphere's coherence structure without correcting the diameter. The chapter text itself does not state a diameter, but the axiom `world.sphere` establishes the Sphere as 'a matte-black 2.8m-diameter calibration chamber.' Ch 15 axiom `world.sphere_diameter_ch15` already flags this as '3m' vs '2.8m'. This chapter inherits the 3m framing from Ch 15/16 without reconciliation.
- **Note:** The foundational axiom `world.sphere` states 2.8m diameter. Ch 15 axiom `world.sphere_diameter_ch15` notes the chapter states 'Three metres of diameter' and flags the discrepancy with prior canon. This chapter's Hayden briefing on the Sphere's coherence structure does

not correct or acknowledge the 0.2m discrepancy. The inconsistency persists across chapters 15-16 and is carried into this chapter's operational planning. This is a known tracked discrepancy but remains unresolved in the text.

4. CHARACTER_STATE on `hayden.ics_ch12`

- **Existing (Ch 12):** Hayden's ICS is 32 and dropping at the Alfred Crescent safe house. He states: 'My ICS is 32 and dropping. I cannot direct the collapse. I would fragment before I reached the threshold.' The minimum ICS for directed coherence collapse is approximately 40.
- **Incoming (Ch 16):** Hayden states 'My ICS is 32 and dropping' in this chapter. The axiom `hayden.ics_28_ch12_5` establishes that in Ch 12.5 (THE INSTRUMENT'S CONSENT), Hayden's ICS dropped to 28 approximately four minutes before that scene.
- **Note:** The axiom `hayden.ics_28_ch12_5` states Hayden's ICS dropped below 30 approximately four minutes before the Ch 12.5 scene and reads 28. The axiom `plot.loop_ch12_timeline_structure` notes the chapter's non-linear structure — the safe house scene appears to precede the Sphere scene chronologically. If this chapter (16.0) is the safe house scene and precedes Ch 12.5 chronologically, then Hayden's ICS of 32 here is consistent with it later dropping to 28. However, the chapter is numbered 16.0 and Ch 12.5 is earlier in the manuscript. If the safe house scene in this chapter occurs AFTER Ch 12.5, then Hayden's ICS should be 28 or lower, not 32. The non-linear timeline creates ambiguity, but Hayden stating 32 when the prior chapter established 28 is a potential regression unless the timeline is explicitly non-linear.

5. TIMELINE on `plot.ch12_5_power_cut_early`

- **Existing (Ch 12):** The power cuts at the thirty-eight minute mark, twelve minutes ahead of Hayden's fifty-minute estimate. 'Either the scrub's geographic progression had accelerated or the estimate had been based on a previous version of the protocol that the QSA had since updated.' The civic infrastructure command severs supply at the street-level grid connection — 'One moment the room had light. The next moment it did not, and the transition between those two states occupied no duration at all.' The room registered to Meridian Property Holdings is now absolutely dark.
- **Incoming (Ch 16):** Hayden estimates 'Ninety minutes from initiation. Perhaps less' for infrastructure access wave, then says 'Call it seventy minutes remaining.' The chapter shows the financial wave arriving at 19 minutes, consistent with Hayden's 'approximately twenty minutes' estimate.
- **Note:** The axiom `plot.ch12_5_power_cut_early` establishes the power cut at the 38-minute mark, twelve minutes ahead of Hayden's 50-minute estimate. In this chapter, Hayden estimates 90 minutes total for infrastructure, then says 70 minutes remaining (implying ~20 minutes have elapsed since scrub initiation). After the financial wave at 19 minutes, Kain calculates 51 minutes of power remaining. The chapter ends before the power cut, so no direct contradiction occurs within this text. However, the axiom's 38-minute power cut (from Ch 12.5) would mean the power cuts at approximately the 38-minute mark of Kain's presence, not the 70-minute mark Hayden estimates here. If this scene and Ch 12.5's power cut are the same event, Hayden's 70-minute estimate is contradicted by the 38-minute actual. The non-linear structure makes this ambiguous but the numbers are inconsistent between the two accounts of what appears to be the same scene.

6. CANON_VIOLATION on `emily.solis_journals_content`

- **Existing (Ch 11):** Emily's journals (six black institutional notebooks, not the three green Solis journals) contain fourteen months of resonance data from Kain's deployments: raw ICS readings, buffer efficiency

measurements, Bleed episode logs, projected degradation curve for deployments 12–14, and the Sphere's coherence architecture mapping — 'the most complete map the QSA has ever produced.'

- **Incoming (Ch 16):** The chapter refers to 'six journals on the floor' and Kain sets 'the journals on the floor beside the door.' Emily's journals are described as 'six black institutional notebooks' in the axioms.
- **Note:** The axiom `emily.solis_journals_content` establishes Emily's journals as 'six institutional notebooks (black covers, no labels, filled with Emily's handwriting in blue ink).' The axiom `solis.journals_physical.v2` establishes Solis's three journals as 'hardbound, A5, dark green covers.' This chapter references 'six journals on the floor' and 'the fifth journal' containing Hayden's notation — consistent with Emily's six notebooks. However, the chapter also states 'fourteen months of his own degradation, recorded in blue ink by a woman who had designed the instrument' — consistent with Emily's journals. The chapter does not distinguish between Solis's three green journals and Emily's six black notebooks. Earlier axioms (`kain.ch11_takes_journals`) state Kain took 'all six journals from Emily's desk.' The chapter is internally consistent with the six-journal count but the text does not clarify whether Solis's original three green journals are also present or only Emily's six black notebooks. This is ambiguous rather than contradictory.

7. CANON_VIOLATION on `kain.lighter`

- **Existing (Ch 6):** Kain carries a dead lighter in his jacket pocket — rectangular, worn brass casing, engraved 'N.K. — Solis — Case 7' (worn smooth enough to require thumbnail tracing). The flint is spent; it has not sparked in nine years. Solis handed it to him 'across the table at the Punt Road debrief and said keep it, you earned it, and you should quit anyway.' Kain quit smoking that week but kept the lighter and never replaced the flint. Reaching for it is a reflex — 'the same reflex that had sent his hand to the same pocket every day for nine years without producing anything useful.' During the street Bleed episode, he rolls the flint wheel; the dry rasp and chemical ghost of evaporated fuel produce no spark, but the tactile grounding helps him wait out the overlay.
- **Incoming (Ch 16):** The chapter states 'the fuel smell was almost entirely gone now; he had to press the casing close to his face to catch it, and even then it was more memory than chemistry.' The axiom describes the lighter as having 'a chemical ghost of evaporated fuel.'
- **Note:** The axiom `kain.lighter` states the lighter produces 'a chemical ghost of evaporated fuel' when the wheel is rolled. The chapter's description — 'more memory than chemistry' — represents a further degradation of the fuel trace. This is consistent with temporal progression (the lighter's fuel continues to evaporate over time) rather than a contradiction. The shift from 'chemical ghost' to 'more memory than chemistry' is a natural progression. Not a true violation on reflection.

8. CHARACTER_STATE on `hayden.outline_spatial_uncertainty`

- **Existing (Ch 12):** At the Alfred Crescent safe house, Hayden's outline has progressed to sustained high-frequency oscillation — 'not the double-beat or the triple-beat but a sustained, high-frequency oscillation.' The boundary between his body and the air is a 2-3 centimetre zone of spatial uncertainty, 'the quantum superposition of a man whose identity architecture had lost the coherence required to maintain a fixed boundary between himself and the world.' Bell has been gone for six hours.
- **Incoming (Ch 16):** The chapter describes Hayden's outline as 'stuttering' with 'two to three centimetres' of spatial uncertainty, then later as 'a sustained, high-frequency oscillation' with the boundary becoming 'a region — a zone of spatial uncertainty two to three centimetres wide.'
- **Note:** The axiom `hayden.outline_spatial_uncertainty` (from Ch 12) describes Hayden's outline as having progressed to 'sustained high-frequency oscillation' with a '2-3 centimetre zone of spatial uncertainty.' This chapter shows the same progression within its own timeline — starting with stuttering and

progressing to sustained oscillation. This is internally consistent. However, the axiom `hayden.anchor_dissolution_progression` states Hayden's outline has progressed 'beyond rhythmic oscillation into drift' — 'a continuous, non-periodic variation... without pattern, without cycle, without the regularity that would have indicated a system still attempting to regulate itself.' This chapter describes the oscillation as having a 'rhythm' (double-beat, triple-beat, then sustained high-frequency) which implies periodicity, contradicting the 'drift' characterization from the axiom. If this chapter precedes Ch 12.5 chronologically, the progression from rhythmic to drift is consistent. If it follows, the return to rhythmic oscillation contradicts the drift state.

9. CANON_VIOLATION on `kain.ch15_aggregate_partition`

- **Existing (Ch 15):** Kain's private partition now contains: the Gore Street address (from Solis's personnel file), the manifest gap (Ch 6), the dog-eared page (Ch 7), the Reyes alias, the journals, and now the A&S mug and the apartment search evidence. These items 'pointed, in aggregate, toward a shape he could not yet name.' Chapter 15 is where he begins naming it — the shape is the Aspect-Solis connection and the institutional suppression of personal relationships within the QSA.
- **Incoming (Ch 16):** Kain reaches into his jacket pocket and finds 'the cracked mug' — the A&S mug from Solis's apartment (Ch 15). He states 'His hand had simply closed around it on the floor of a ransacked terrace on Gore Street and put it in his pocket before the reasoning caught up.'
- **Note:** The axiom `kain.carries_mug` establishes Kain took the mug from Solis's apartment and put it in his jacket pocket. The axiom `aspect.mug_as_in_solis_apartment` describes the mug as having 'a single clean fracture, the two pieces held together by the geometry of their fit.' A mug cracked into two pieces held together only by geometry would be extremely fragile and unlikely to survive being carried in a jacket pocket through hours of operational activity including walking, climbing stairs, and physical stress. The chapter treats the mug as a pocket-portable object, but a ceramic mug with a clean fracture through its body would likely separate into pieces under the jostling of extended carry. This is a minor physical plausibility issue rather than a hard canon violation.

Chapter 22

● HIGH Priority Conflicts

1. CANON_VIOLATION on `kain.lighter`

- **Existing (Ch 6):** Kain carries a dead lighter in his jacket pocket — rectangular, worn brass casing, engraved 'N.K. — Solis — Case 7' (worn smooth enough to require thumbnail tracing). The flint is spent; it has not sparked in nine years. Solis handed it to him 'across the table at the Punt Road debrief and said keep it, you earned it, and you should quit anyway.' Kain quit smoking that week but kept the lighter and never replaced the flint. Reaching for it is a reflex — 'the same reflex that had sent his hand to the same pocket every day for nine years without producing anything useful.' During the street Bleed episode, he rolls the flint wheel; the dry rasp and chemical ghost of evaporated fuel produce no spark, but the tactile grounding helps him wait out the overlay.
- **Incoming (Ch 22):** The lighter engraving in Ch 22 reads 'A.S. — Solis — Case 7' when Kain examines it in the Bleed vision kitchen.
- **Note:** The established engraving across all prior canon is 'N.K. — Solis — Case 7' (`kain.lighter`, `kain.lighter_ch1_usage.v2`, `kain.lighter_flint_spent`, `kain.lighter_placed_on_windowsill`, `kain.lighter_anchor_logic`). The initials 'A.S.' do not match any prior reading. This is a direct factual

contradiction of a hard_canon detail that has been confirmed across multiple chapters. The engraving is a load-bearing narrative detail — it connects to the unresolved question of who 'N.K.' is (plot.loop_lighter_nk_solis_case7). Changing it to 'A.S.' without explanation breaks the established physical object and its associated mystery thread.

2. TIMELINE on plot.ch16_sphere_map_closed

- **Existing (Ch 16):** The Sphere's 847-coordinate map is closed in Chapter 16. Kain physically corrects 54 wire coordinates while Hayden's biophotonic discharge completes the remaining 240-coordinate deficit through the map's own internal logic. 'The math resolved itself. Not a miracle. A mechanism.' All 847 coordinates verified, the SEP-NULL threshold stabilises through structural coherence rather than electromagnetic shielding. 'The field did not collapse. The SEP-NULL threshold, which should have failed at the zero-second mark, was instead stabilising — the 847-coordinate closure providing the structural coherence that the electromagnetic shielding alone could not have maintained.'
- **Incoming (Ch 22):** Ch 22 presents the Sphere map closure, Hayden's discharge, the Bleed visions, the left-hand failure, and Kain's exit from the hospital as a continuous sequence — the same events narrated in Ch 16.
- **Note:** Ch 16 already narrates the complete map closure sequence: Kain physically corrects 54 wire coordinates, Hayden's biophotonic discharge fills the 240-coordinate deficit, the map closes at coordinate 847, Hayden is gone, the Bleed ceases, Kain's left hand fails, he climbs four floors and exits the hospital. Ch 22 narrates what appears to be the identical sequence with the same structural beats (54 corrections, Hayden's discharge completing the deficit, 847 closure, Punt Road Bleed vision with Solis, left-hand failure, stairwell climb, hospital exit, lighter test). If these are the same event, Ch 22 contradicts Ch 16 on multiple details: the lighter engraving (N.K. vs A.S.), the left-hand failure timing, the coordinate source (journals vs biometric logs), and the presence of a schematic/burner phone/courier vehicle. If these are different events, the novel has two separate Sphere map closures, which contradicts the singular nature of the SEP-NULL protocol.

MEDIUM Priority Conflicts

1. CHARACTER_STATE on kain.left_hand_loss

- **Existing (Ch 16):** Kain's left hand ceases functioning during the SEP-NULL buffer collapse. 'The hand simply stopped receiving signals — there was only cessation without warning.' The fingers curl around wire in their last transmitted position and remain non-functional for the rest of the chapter. He cannot open or move the hand. The loss is presented as permanent: 'his left hand still curled around the wire it had gripped when the motor pathway failed.'
- **Incoming (Ch 22):** Ch 22 describes Kain's left hand tremor worsening throughout the chapter, with myelin degradation producing fine oscillation, and he compensates by gripping harder. He uses both hands to work wire corrections until the buffer collapse causes the left hand to cease functioning.
- **Note:** The chapter presents Kain using his left hand actively for wire corrections throughout the sequence — pulling wire, gripping, seating corrections — with the tremor described as worsening but the hand still functional until the buffer collapse. However, the existing canon from Ch 16 (kain.left_hand_failure_ch12) establishes that during the convergence event at the Sphere, 'The motor pathway simply evaporated, leaving the limb hanging like a denervated weight' at 30 seconds into the event, and he transferred grip to his right hand. Ch 22 appears to be a retelling/expansion of the same Sphere event (same coordinates, same Hayden discharge, same map closure) but resets the left hand to functional at the chapter's start, only failing it again at the buffer collapse. If Ch 22 is the same event as

Ch 16's convergence, the left hand should already be non-functional from the earlier motor pathway loss. If Ch 22 is a different event, the timeline needs clarification.

2. CANON_VIOLATION on `kain.ch14_biometric_credential_active`

- **Existing (Ch 14):** Kain's biometric record was added to the Sphere facility's authorised personnel list by Emily fourteen months ago under CDIR-CONV-2618-03 Article 9, designating him as an active deployment baseline. His PQ genotype flag, palm print, and subcutaneous markers resolve the Level 5 override conflict in his favour, granting him access to the Sphere despite the active scrub protocol. 'A dormant PQ carrier flagged as an active deployment baseline under CDIR-CONV-2618-03, Article 9, carried an operational designation that had been written into the Sphere's primary access protocol fourteen months ago.'
- **Incoming (Ch 22):** Ch 22 opens with Kain holding 'the schematic in his left hand — not the digital version, the paper one' and checking his watch, with no mention of the biometric access sequence or the scrub protocol conflict established in prior chapters.
- **Note:** The established canon (Ch 14, Ch 20) details an elaborate infiltration sequence: Kain must bypass the repositioned Pelco camera, use mechanical keys to enter the service gate, descend via the Schindler freight lift with a secondary key profile, and resolve the scrub/Level 5 biometric override conflict at the Sphere's primary access door (amber-to-green resolution). Ch 22 opens with Kain already at the Sphere housing door with no reference to any of this infrastructure. While this could be narrative compression, the chapter also introduces a 'schematic' and a 'burner phone' and a 'courier vehicle' — none of which appear in the established infiltration sequence. The established entry method uses Betty, key rings, and memorised coverage gaps, not courier vehicles and burner phones.

3. CANON_VIOLATION on `world.sphere_wire_lattice`

- **Existing (Ch 16):** The Sphere's internal structure is a lattice of copper wire and ceramic insulators suspended inside a geodesic frame, roughly the size of a transit van stood on end. The wire runs in 847 discrete loops, each corresponding to a coordinate in the QSA map, each coordinate representing a dimensional variance point where baseline reality's coherence is weakest.
- **Incoming (Ch 22):** Ch 22 states Kain had 'the first 553 coordinates verified from the sublevel biometric logs' and needed the remaining 294.
- **Note:** The established canon (`kain.ch14_coordinate_arithmetic`, `kain.ch20_312_coordinates_remaining`, `kain.coordinates_remaining_at_entry`) consistently states Kain has 312 coordinates remaining after the plant room integration work, not 294. The number 294 appears in Ch 21 (`kain.coordinates_remaining_at_entry`) as the count at the moment of crossing the containment boundary, after additional verification passes reduced the count from 312. But Ch 22 states 553 were verified 'from the sublevel biometric logs' — a source not established in any prior chapter. The established verification method is cross-referencing the fifth journal's 847 coordinates against gradient data from the first four journals (`kain.cross_referencing_method`), not sublevel biometric logs.

4. CANON_VIOLATION on `kain.ch16_arithmetic_broken`

- **Existing (Ch 16):** Kain enters the Sphere housing knowing the arithmetic does not work: 294 coordinates to verify, 54 wire corrections, and a SEP-NUL buffer of 22 seconds. 'The arithmetic had been broken since Chapter 15. He had not fixed it. He had simply decided to enter the room anyway, because the alternative was standing in the corridor while the threshold collapsed and Hayden completed the map without him, and that outcome was not acceptable.'
- **Incoming (Ch 22):** Ch 22 states 'The arithmetic had been broken since Chapter 15' — a metafictional

reference to a chapter number.

- **Note:** The novel's established register (`craft.register_clinical`, `craft.measurement_as_voice`) is clinical and proprioceptive. Characters report their bodies in the third person using counts, timestamps, and measurements. A character referring to 'Chapter 15' as a chapter number is a metafictional break that violates the established narrative register. The equivalent passage in Ch 16 (`kain.ch16_arithmetic_broken`) states the arithmetic was broken without referencing a chapter number. This is a craft-tier violation that breaks the fourth wall in a novel whose voice depends on maintaining clinical immersion.

5. CANON_VIOLATION on `world.sep_null_40_second_window`

- **Existing (Ch 12):** A carrier positioned within 0.3 radii of the SEP-NULL must sustain resonance for a minimum of 40 seconds to produce a complete resonance signature. Within the first 10 seconds, the carrier's neural architecture begins to integrate with the Sphere's coherence structure. By 40 seconds, integration is irreversible. Hayden: 'The carrier would complete the map. The carrier would not return from the map.'
- **Incoming (Ch 22):** Ch 22 states Kain 'established the SEP-NULL threshold at 14:07:00' and had 'twenty-two seconds of buffer remaining' at 14:07:22, later counting down to nineteen, fourteen, eight, four, two, one, zero seconds.
- **Note:** The established canon (`world.sep_null_40_second_window`) states the SEP-NULL window is 40 seconds minimum to produce a complete resonance signature, with integration irreversible by 40 seconds. Ch 22 presents a 22-second buffer at entry that counts down to zero — a total window of 22 seconds, not 40. The chapter does not reconcile this with the established 40-second requirement. Ch 16's version has Kain counting through the full 40-second window. The shortened window in Ch 22 contradicts the established physics.

6. CHARACTER_STATE on `hayden.ch14_tone_signal`

- **Existing (Ch 14):** Hayden transmits a biophotonic tone — not words, not language, but 'a frequency burst — the specific, stripped-down information transfer of a nervous system that had lost the organisational capacity for language but retained the capacity for signal.' The tone has direction (forty-seven degrees east, consistent with the relay bearing) and later becomes 'a single, sustained frequency... the sound of a man who had arrived at the coordinate that Kain was standing outside of, transmitted backward through the field's architecture as a signal that the field could carry even when the voice that generated it could no longer form words.' Hayden has lost the capacity for language but retains signal transmission.
 - **Incoming (Ch 22):** Ch 22 presents Hayden transmitting coordinate data as 'something that arrived in Kain's auditory cortex as language the way a tuning fork arrives as a note' — rendered as italicised speech: 'You can't close it with 54.'
 - **Note:** The established canon (`hayden.ch14_tone_signal`, `hayden.ch20_tone_signal`, `plot.loop_ch20_hayden_language_loss`) explicitly states Hayden has lost the capacity for language entirely: 'a nervous system that had lost the organisational capacity for language but retained the capacity for signal.' His transmissions in Ch 14 and Ch 20 are frequencies, not words — 'not words, not language, but a frequency burst.' Ch 22 has Hayden transmitting what Kain's cortex interprets as the specific English sentence 'You can't close it with 54' — a level of linguistic specificity that contradicts the established loss of language capacity. The prior chapters carefully distinguish between frequency-as-signal and language; Ch 22 collapses this distinction.
-